SongLens User Guide

Version 1.1.4

Browsing, inspecting, searching, and documenting Studio One songs

SongLens

SongLens is a Windows desktop app for browsing Studio One `.song` files, inspecting metadata, reviewing tracks and mixer details, and exporting useful song information without opening every project in Studio One.

It is designed for composers, producers, and power users who want a fast way to search a song library and inspect what is inside a project at a glance.

Start Here

- Getting Started
- Browsing Folders And Songs
- Search And Filters
- Detail Tabs
- Exports And Snapshots
- Preferences And Themes
- Tips And Compatibility

What SongLens Does

- Browses a Studio One songs folder with a filtered folder tree
- Reads `.song` files locally without requiring network access
- Shows summary metadata such as title, artist, tempo, key, time signature, Studio Version, and file dates
- Displays filtered raw attributes from `metainfo.xml`
- Lists tracks, instruments, track notes, and groups
- Shows mixer data in separate Main, Inserts, and Sends sections
- Reads song notes from `notes.txt`
- Opens the song History browser for saved history copies
- Searches across song metadata, notes, and track details
- Exports search results or library views to CSV
- Creates musician-friendly song snapshots in Text or JSON

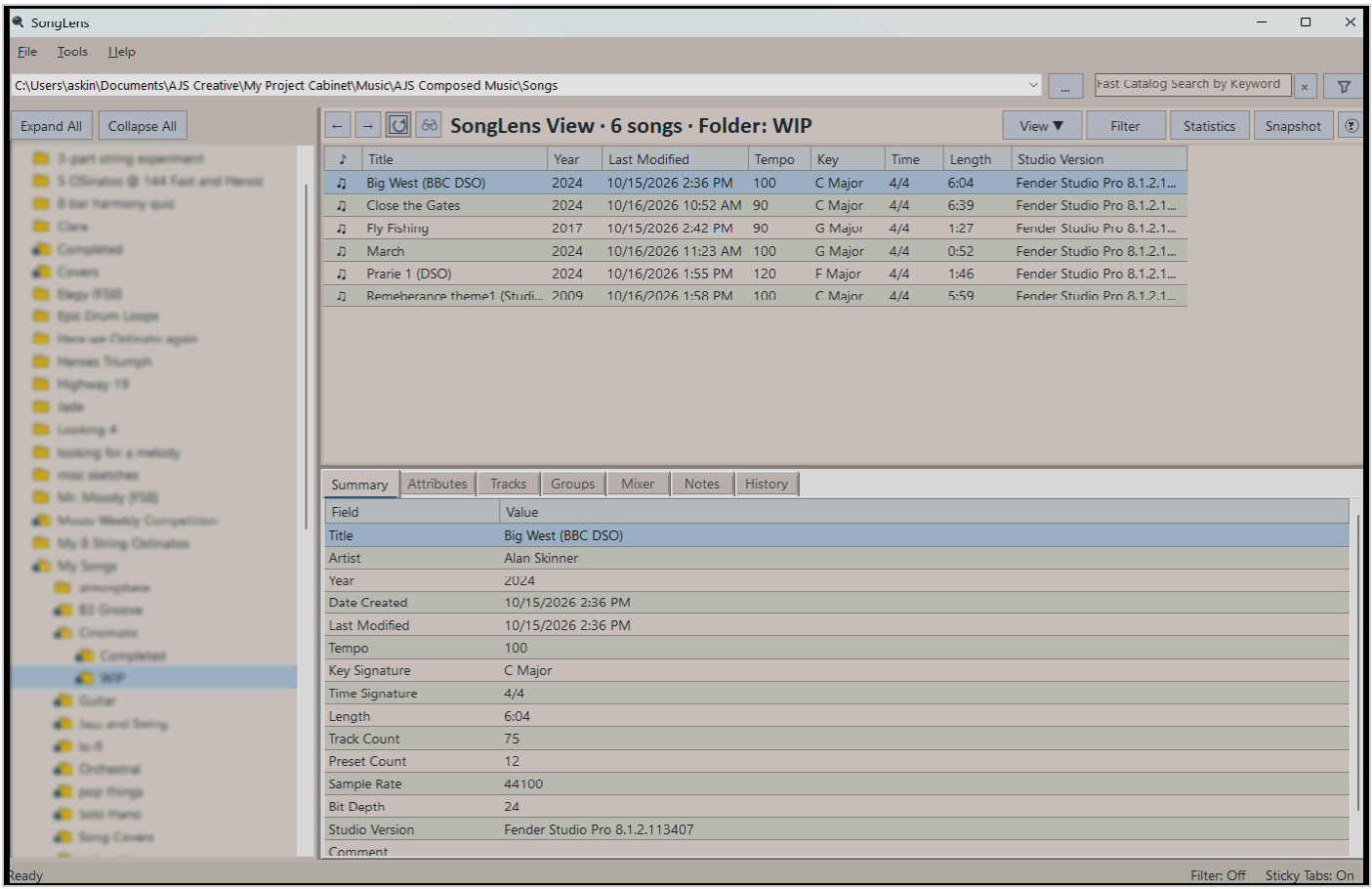
Main Window Overview

SongLens is organized into three main areas:

- Folder tree on the left
- SongLens View on the upper right
- Detail tabs on the lower right

The app also includes:

- A top path and search area
- Toolbar buttons for folder and browsing actions
- A binoculars button for `Recently Viewed` beside the SongLens View navigation controls
- Menus and toolbar buttons for export, filtering, preferences, and advanced features



SongLens main window with SongLens View and the Summary tab

Common Tasks

- Browse to a songs folder and inspect projects without opening Studio One
- Search for songs by title, artist, tempo, key, notes, track names, and more
- Review track instruments, groups, mixer inserts, mixer sends, and mixer main chains
- Export the current view to CSV
- Save a snapshot of a song in Text or JSON format

Getting Started

Quick Start

1. Launch SongLens.
2. Choose your Studio One songs folder if SongLens does not already have one saved.
3. Use the folder tree on the left to browse folders that contain visible `.song` files.
4. Click a folder to load its songs into SongLens View.
5. Click a song to load its details into the tabs below.
6. Double-click a song row to reveal the file in Windows Explorer, or right-click it for song actions.

Opening Songs In Compatible Apps

Right-click a song and choose `Open in Recommended App` to launch it in the app it was last saved with.

If an alternate compatible app is available, SongLens can also show `Open in Alternate App`.

The default behavior is configured so launching the recommended app is available by default.

What SongLens Reads

Studio One `.song` files are zip archives. SongLens reads internal files such as:

- `metainfo.xml`
- `Song/song.xml`
- `Devices/musictrackdevice.xml`
- `Devices/audiosynthfolder.xml`
- `notepad.xml`
- `notes.txt`

These sources are used to assemble the Summary, Attributes, Tracks, Groups, Mixer, Notes, and search data.

Browsing Folders And Songs

Folder Tree

The folder tree shows folders that contain visible `.song` files somewhere below them. Per-song `History` folders are excluded so saved revisions do not appear as duplicate catalog songs.

Folder Tree Features

- `Expand All` opens all visible folders below the current songs root
- `Collapse All` closes child folders, leaves the root open, and scrolls back to the top
- Clicking a folder loads songs for that folder
- If a folder has subfolders, a single click also expands it
- Right-clicking a folder opens a context menu with actions such as:
- `Reveal in Explorer`
- `Expand Folder`
- `Collapse Folder`
- `Delete Folder`

Folder Loading Behavior

- If search results are showing and you click a folder, SongLens exits search mode and loads that folder immediately
- If a root or selected folder effectively leads to one visible song, SongLens can load it automatically so the detail area is not blank
- Automatic loading is tuned so larger folders do not flood `Recently Viewed` with unwanted first-song selections

SongLens View

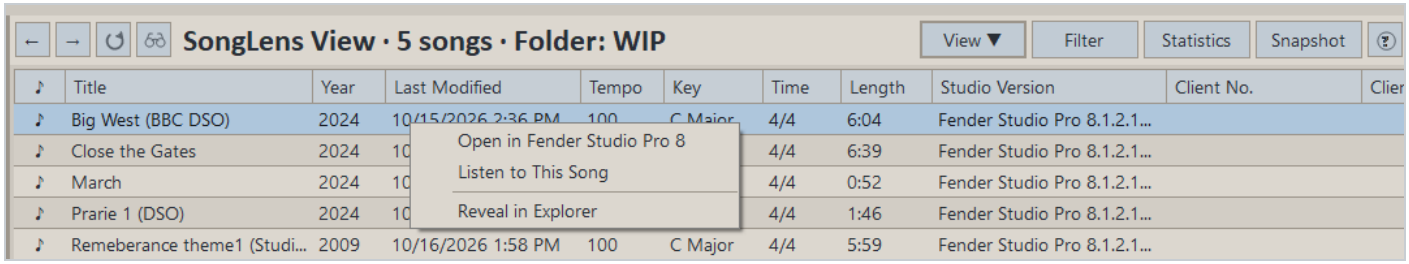
SongLens View lists the songs for the selected folder, or the current search results when search mode is active. History revisions are excluded from folder views, searches, and catalog exports.

Fast Search checks the full configured songs root and includes Status, Genre, filename, title, artist, musical metadata, comments, notes, tracks, instruments, and track notes. When the search text exactly matches an assigned Status or Genre option, SongLens treats it as a classification search. For example, a `Hybrid` genre search will not include an unrelated song merely because it contains a track named `Hybrid Keys`.

SongLens View Features

- Sort by clicking column headers

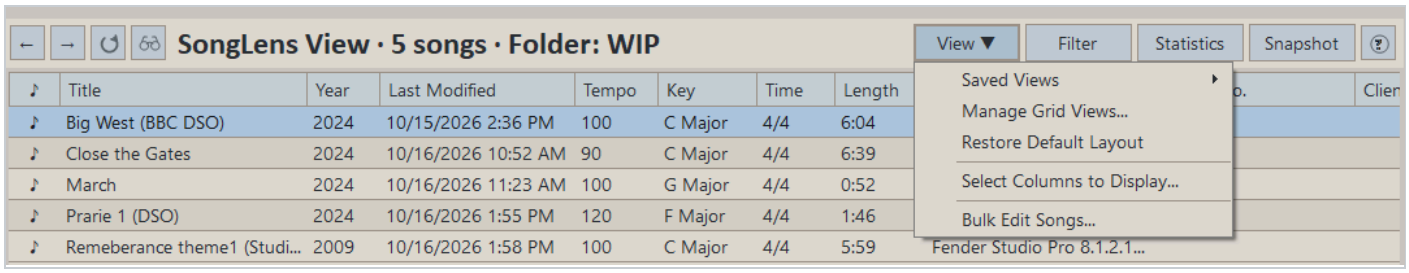
- Drag column headers horizontally to reorder them; SongLens remembers the order
- Resize columns and SongLens will remember those widths
- Choose a workflow status directly from the Status dropdown
- Choose a genre directly from the Genre dropdown
- Rate a song from one to five stars by clicking the Rating column; click the same star again to clear the rating
- Open `Statistics` to summarize the current SongLens View with counts, percentages, and distribution bars
- Double-click a song row to reveal it in Windows Explorer
- Right-click a song row to open actions such as:
- `Open in Recommended App`
- `Open in Alternate App`
- `Listen to This Song` when a matching Mixdown audio file is available
- `Rename Song`
- `Reveal in Explorer`



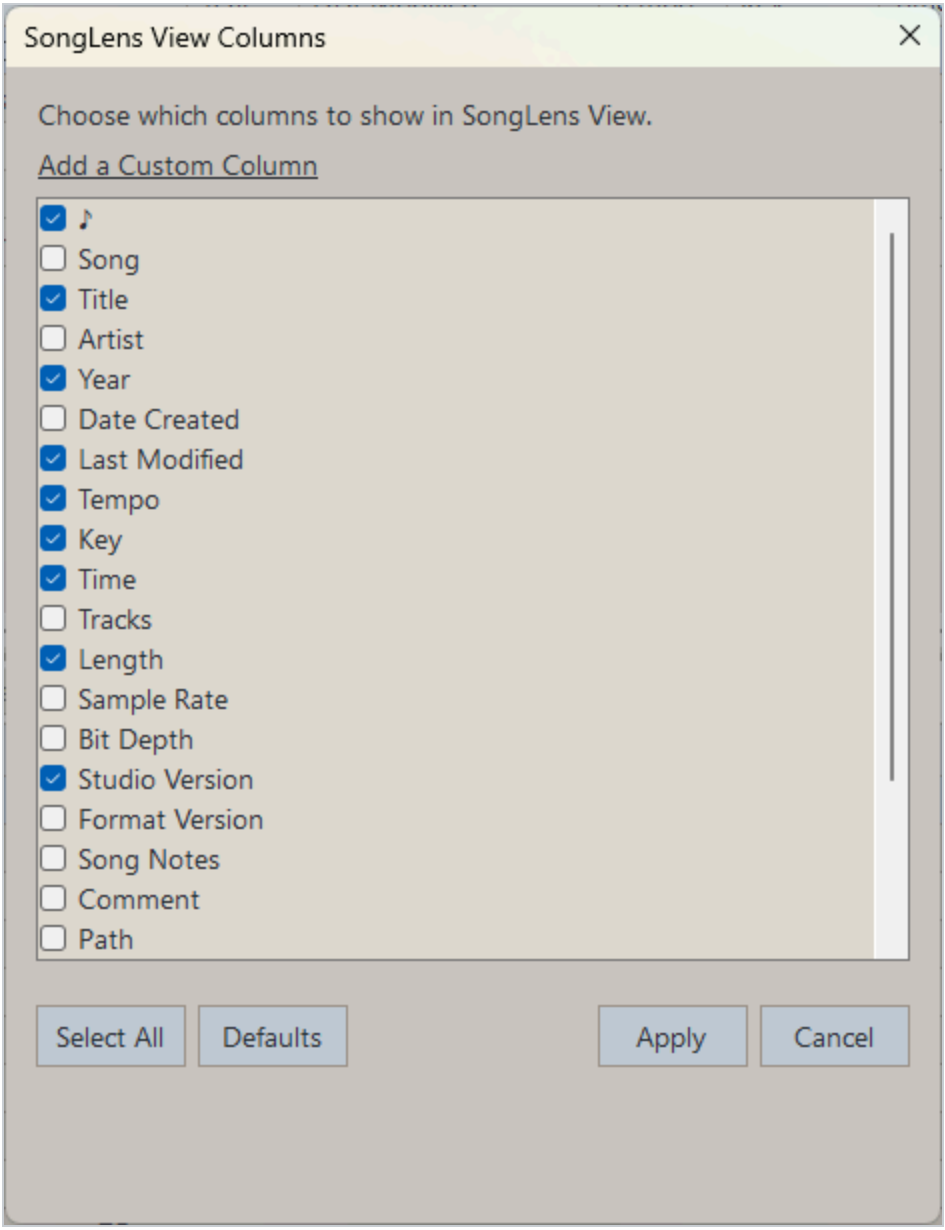
Song row context menu

SongLens View Columns

Use **View > Select Columns to Display** to choose which columns are shown.



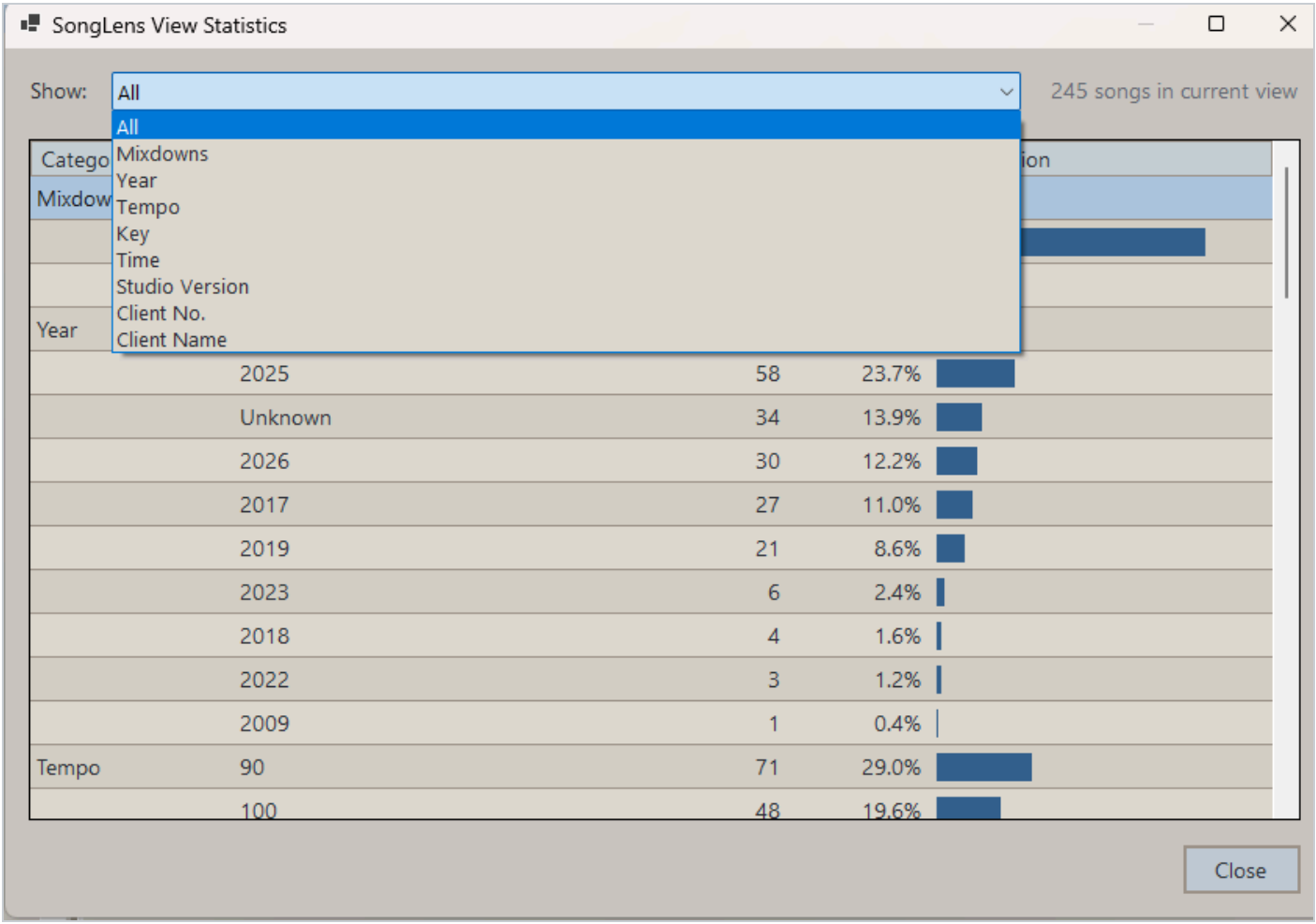
View menu



Select SongLens View columns

Statistics

The `Statistics` button summarizes the songs currently listed in SongLens View. The header labels this count explicitly as songs in the current view and identifies its source, such as the selected folder, active date filter, fast search, advanced search, or the all-songs view. Choose `All` to see every available distribution together, or choose one field from the dropdown. The choices follow the visible columns that produce useful distributions, including Rating, Status, Genre, Artist, Year, Tempo, Key Signature, Time Signature, Track Count, audio format fields, Studio Version, and mixdown availability. Each result shows the number of songs, its percentage of the current view, and a horizontal distribution bar. Unrated songs, songs without a status or genre, and missing metadata are counted explicitly.



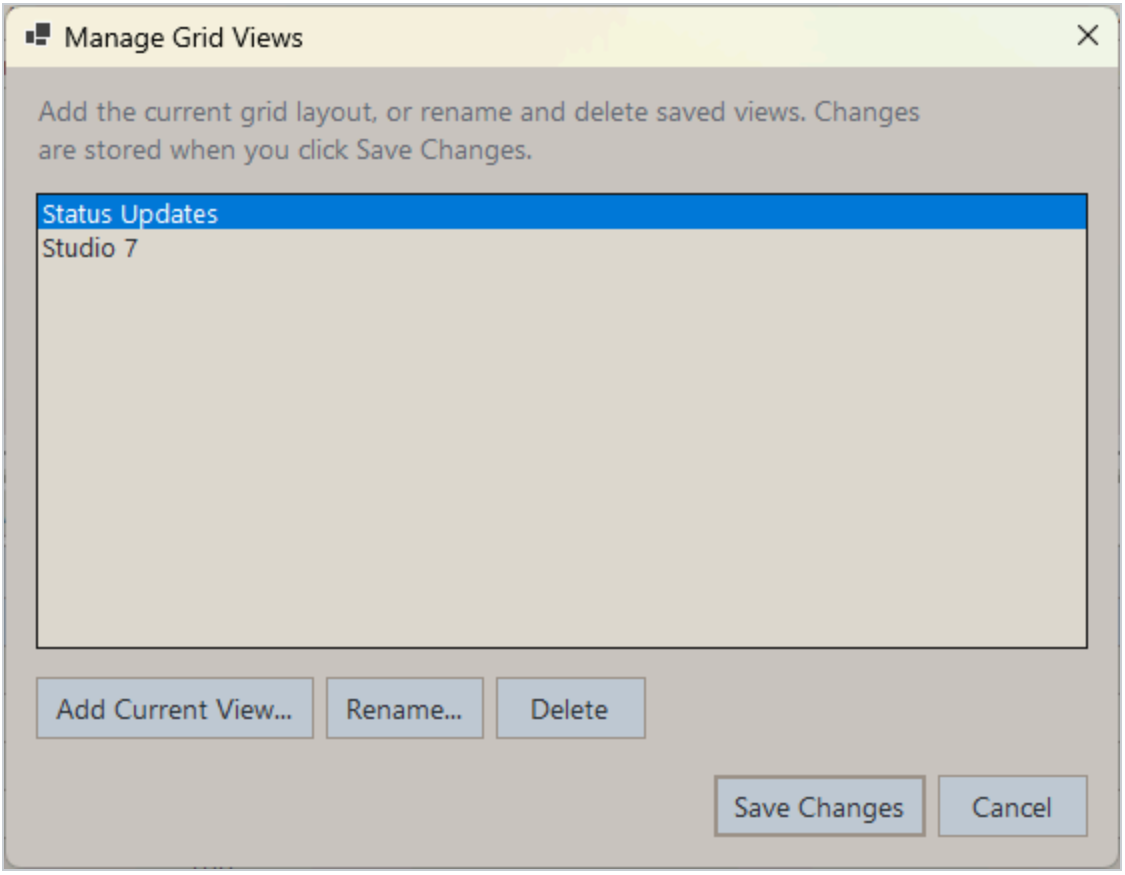
SongLens View Statistics

When the current view contains one song, Statistics automatically becomes a catalog comparison. Each row shows that song's value, how many songs in the full configured catalog share it, and the catalog percentage. Tempo comparisons use ten-BPM ranges while still showing the song's exact tempo. Catalog metadata is cached until the root changes, a folder is rescanned or deleted, or a song is renamed.

The compact header groups related commands beneath `View` and `Filter`. `View` contains Saved Views, Manage Grid Views, Restore Default Layout, and Select Columns to Display. The binoculars icon opens Recently Viewed.

Saved Views

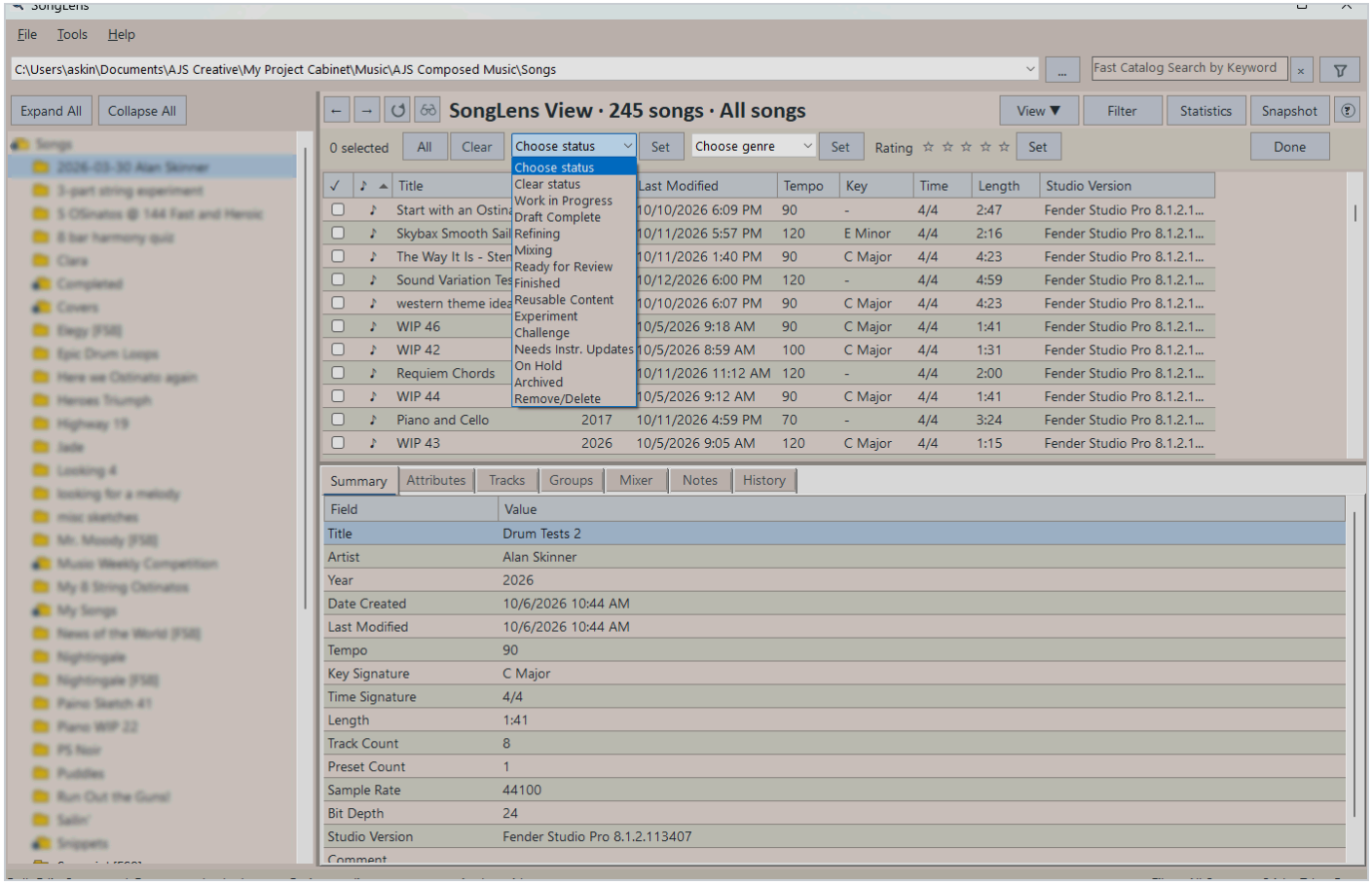
Use **View > Manage Grid Views** to add the current SongLens layout under a name, rename saved views, or delete them. A saved view captures visible columns, column order and widths, and the active sort. When a date filter is active, you can include it or save the layout alone. Choose a name under **View > Saved Views** to restore it. **Restore Default Layout** returns to SongLens's built-in columns, widths, order, and song-name sort without changing the songs currently displayed.



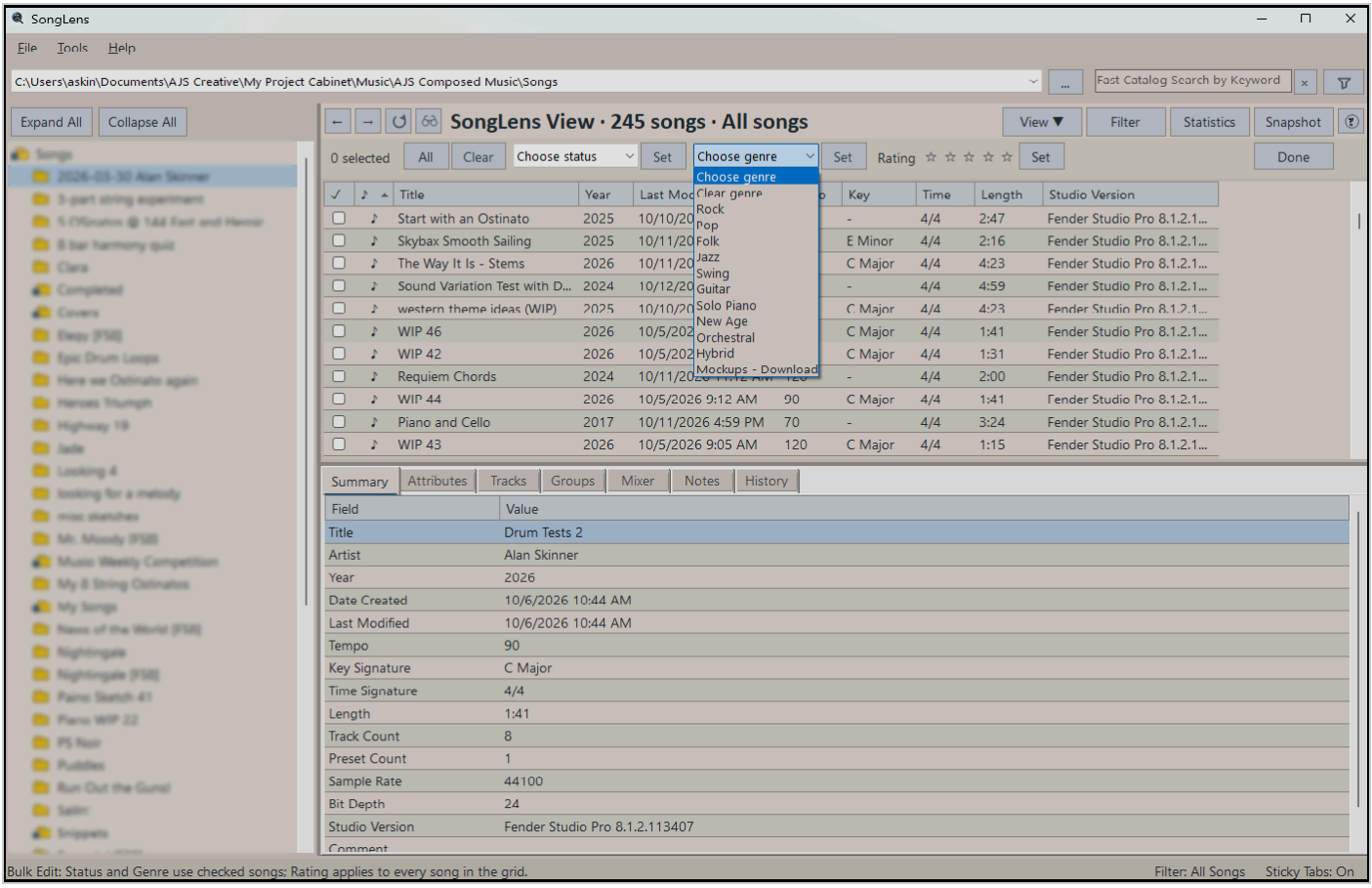
Manage saved grid views

Status, Genre, and Rating are stored by SongLens and do not modify the Studio One `.song` file. SongLens starts with Unfinished, In Progress, Draft Complete, Refining, Mixing, Ready for Review, Finished, On Hold, Archived, and Remove/Delete. Use **Preferences > Statuses** to add, rename, remove, or reorder these options. Removing an option preserves it on songs already using it, while renaming one updates existing assignments. Genre starts with Rock, Pop, Folk, Jazz, Guitar, Solo Piano, Orchestral, and Hybrid; use **Preferences > Genres** to manage that list in the same way. These annotations are retained when a song is renamed from SongLens and are included in catalog exports.

Bulk Edit applies Status or Genre to checked songs and Rating to every song in the current grid. Click **Done** to return to the regular SongLens View.



Bulk Edit status options



Bulk Edit genre options

Use the **Refresh** icon beside the SongLens View heading after files change on disk. It rebuilds the folder catalog and reapplies the current folder, all-songs filter, Fast Search, or Advanced Search view.

The musical-note column identifies songs with supported audio in their configured mixdown folder. A single note (`â™ª`) means one mixdown is available; double-click it to play that file with the configured audio player. A double note (`â™«`) means multiple mixdowns are available. Double-click it to open a version-selection dialog, where you can double-click a version or select it and click **Play This Version**. The existing right-click **Listen to This Song** menu remains available as an alternative. SongLens shows every supported file in that folder even when an older mixdown name no longer matches a renamed song. Files that still match the current song name are listed first, and both selection methods show each file's modified date to help you choose which one to open.

Recently Viewed

Click the binoculars icon beside Refresh to open or close Recently Viewed.

How It Works

- Shows recently opened songs by song filename only
- Avoids filling the list with automatic first-song selections from larger folders
- Can add a song automatically when you intentionally open a folder that contains only one visible song
- Tracks the specific song you click when a folder contains multiple songs

Search And Filters

Fast Catalog Search

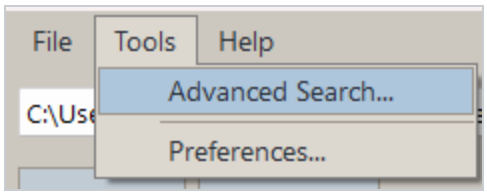
Use the `Fast Catalog Search by Keyword` box to search all songs under the current root folder.

Fast search looks across:

- Filename
- Title
- Artist
- Year
- Tempo
- Key
- Time signature
- Comment
- Notes
- Track names
- Instrument names
- Track notes

Advanced Search

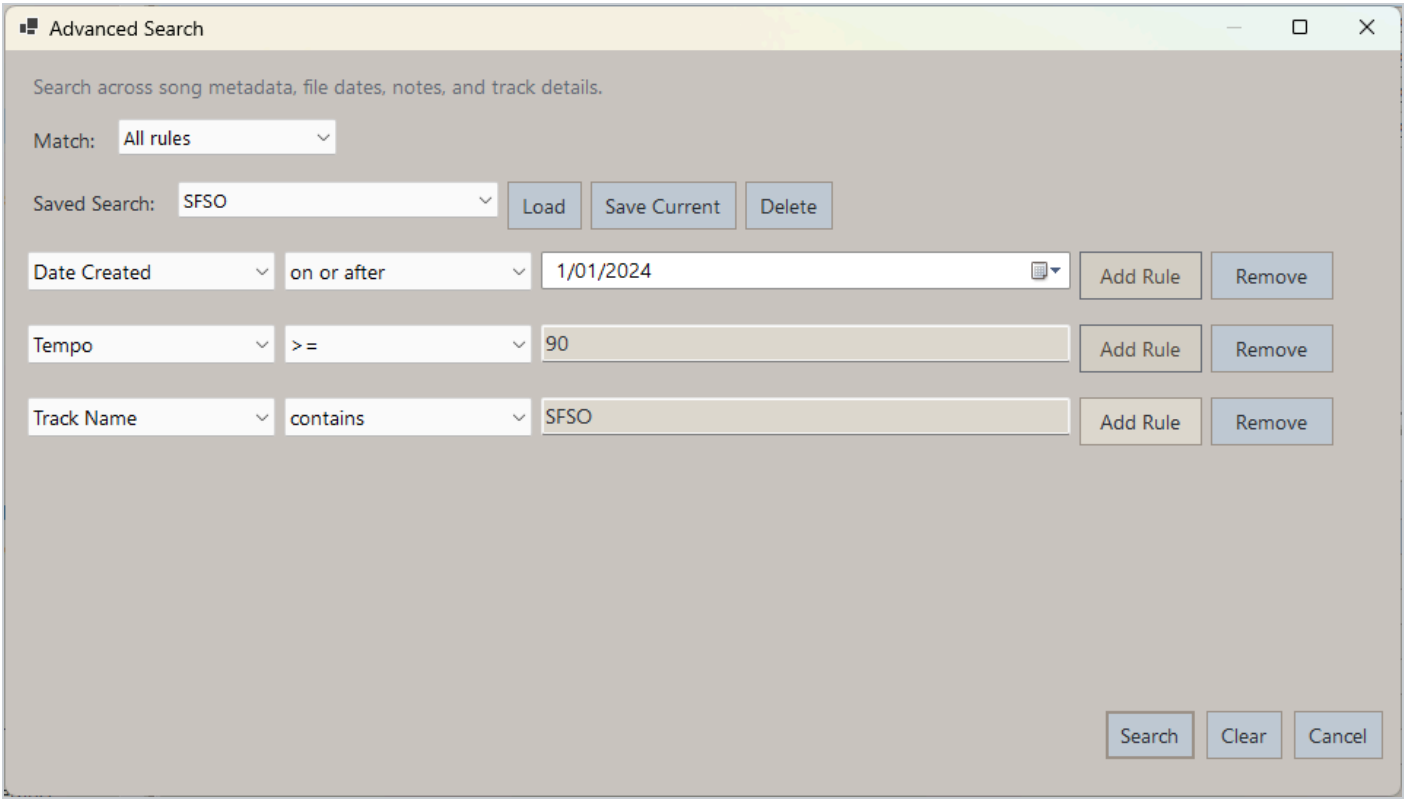
Use the funnel button or `Tools > Advanced Search...` for more targeted searching.



Tools menu

Advanced Search supports:

- `All rules` or `Any rules`
- Saved searches
- Reloading saved searches
- String matching such as `is` and `contains`
- Numeric comparisons
- Date-based rules
- Searching across song metadata, notes, and track details



Advanced Search

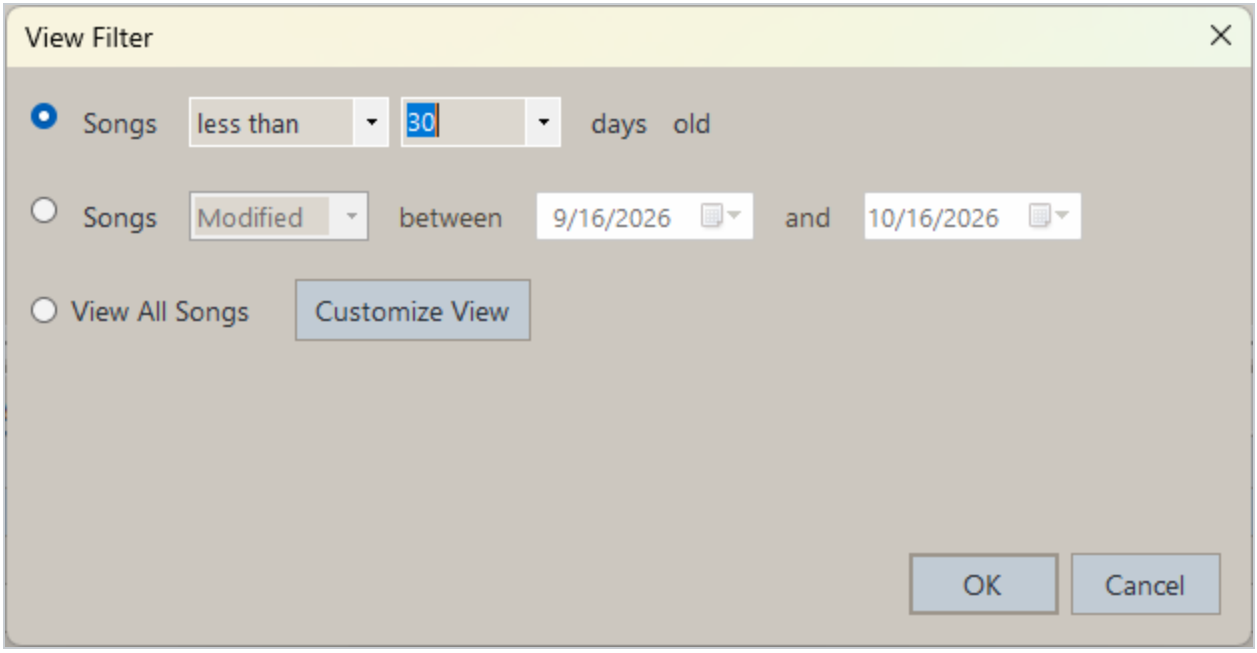
Song Filter

Use the `Filter` button above SongLens View to control which songs are shown.

The filter dialog supports:

- Showing all songs
- Filtering songs by age in days
- Filtering songs between two dates
- Choosing whether the date filter uses `Modified` or `Created`

The folder tree respects the current filter, so folders can appear or disappear when the filter changes.



View Filter dialog

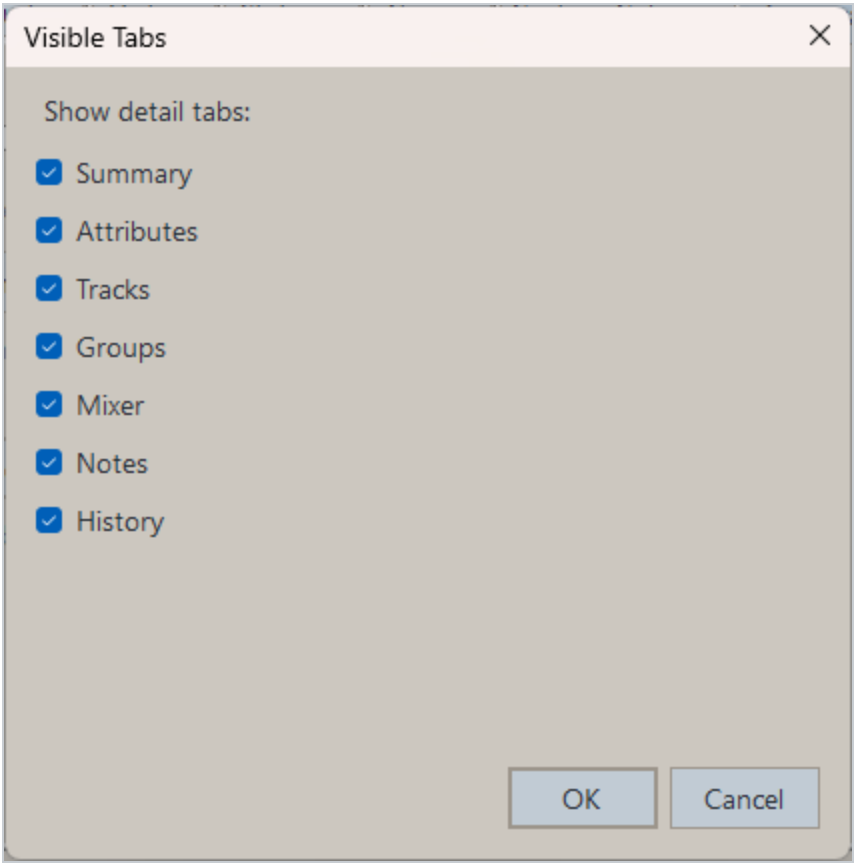
Searchable Fields

- Filename
- Title
- Artist
- Year
- Date created
- Last modified
- Tempo
- Key
- Time signature
- Track count
- Sample rate
- Bit depth
- Comment
- Notes
- Saved In
- Path
- Folder name
- Track name
- Instrument name
- Track note

Detail Tabs

The lower panel shows detail tabs for the selected song.

Use **Tools > Preferences > Appearance > Select Visible Tabs** to show or hide tabs you do not use often.



Choose visible detail tabs

Use **Tools > Preferences > General > Use Sticky Tabs** to keep the current detail tab selected while moving between songs.

Summary

Shows high-level metadata such as:

- Title
- Artist
- Year
- Date Created
- Last Modified
- Tempo

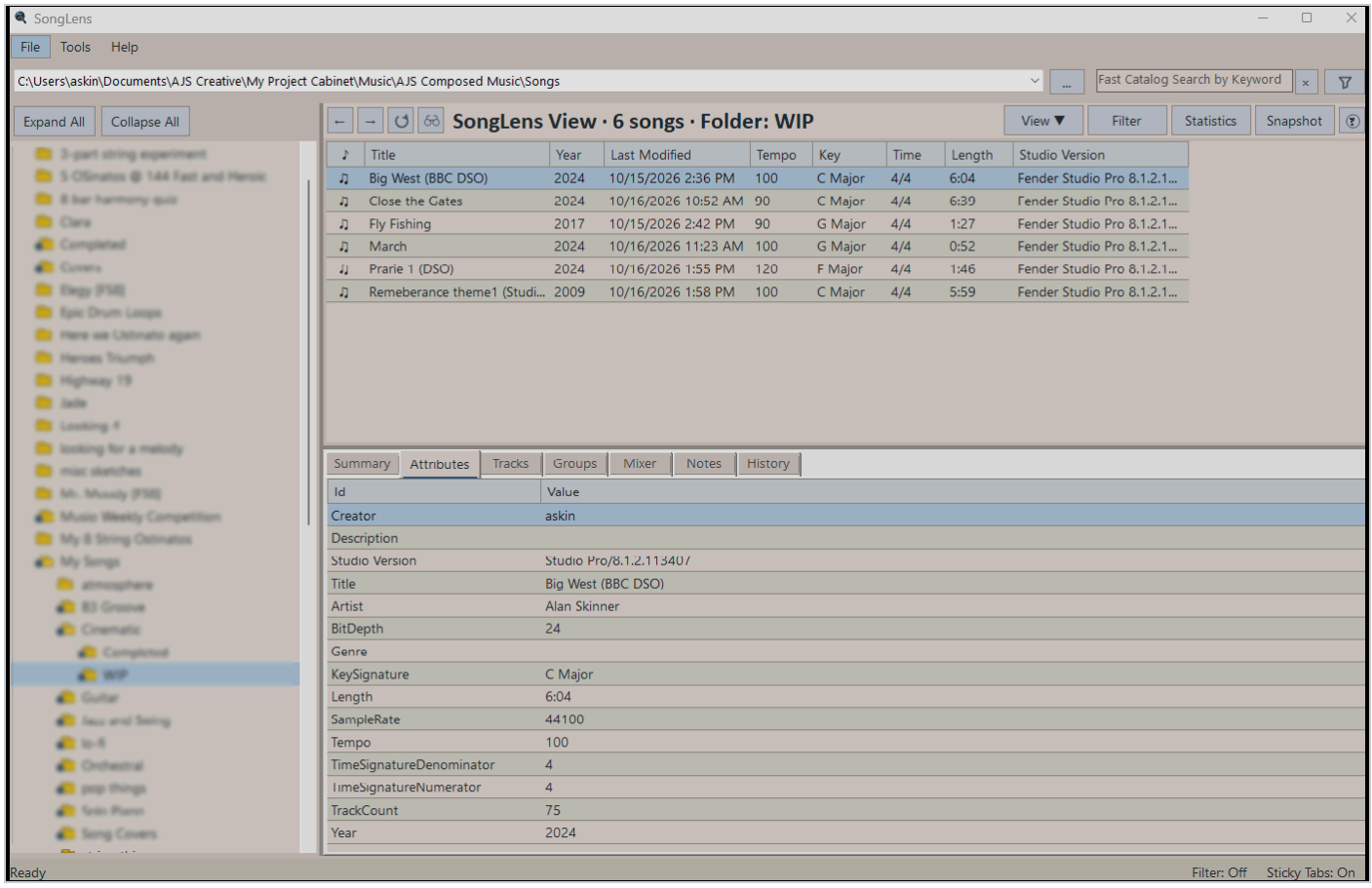
- Key Signature
- Time Signature
- Length
- Track Count
- Preset Count
- Sample Rate
- Bit Depth
- Studio Version
- Comment
- Path

Note: `Date Created` reflects the Windows file creation date, which can differ from the musical history of the song if the file was copied or restored.

Attributes

Shows filtered `metainfo.xml` values for deeper inspection.

For readability, common `Document:` and `Media:` prefixes are removed from the displayed attribute names.



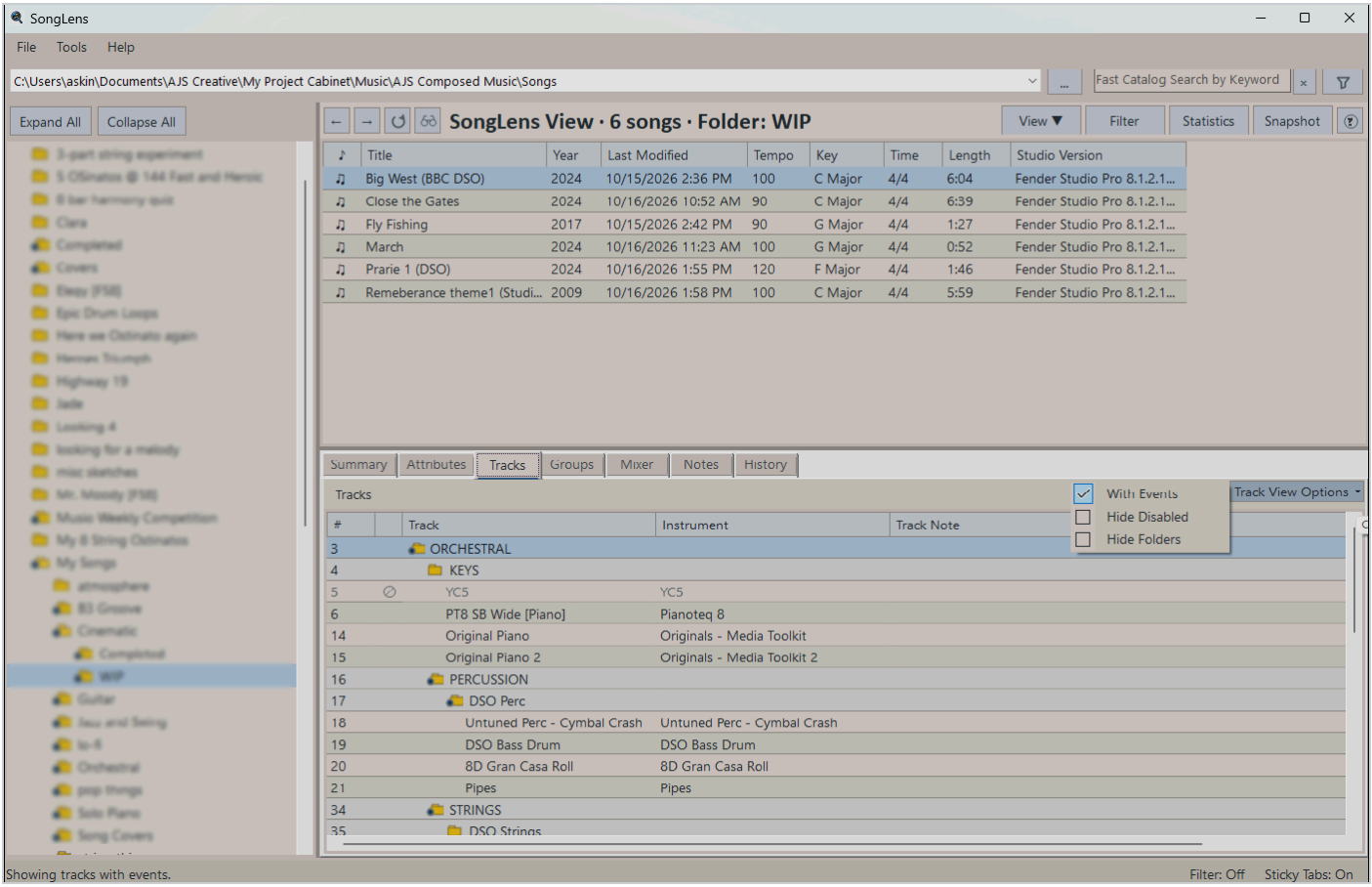
Attributes detail tab

Tracks

Shows track-level information such as:

- Track number
- Track name
- Instrument
- Track note

When possible, SongLens shows the real routed instrument name instead of only repeating the track name.



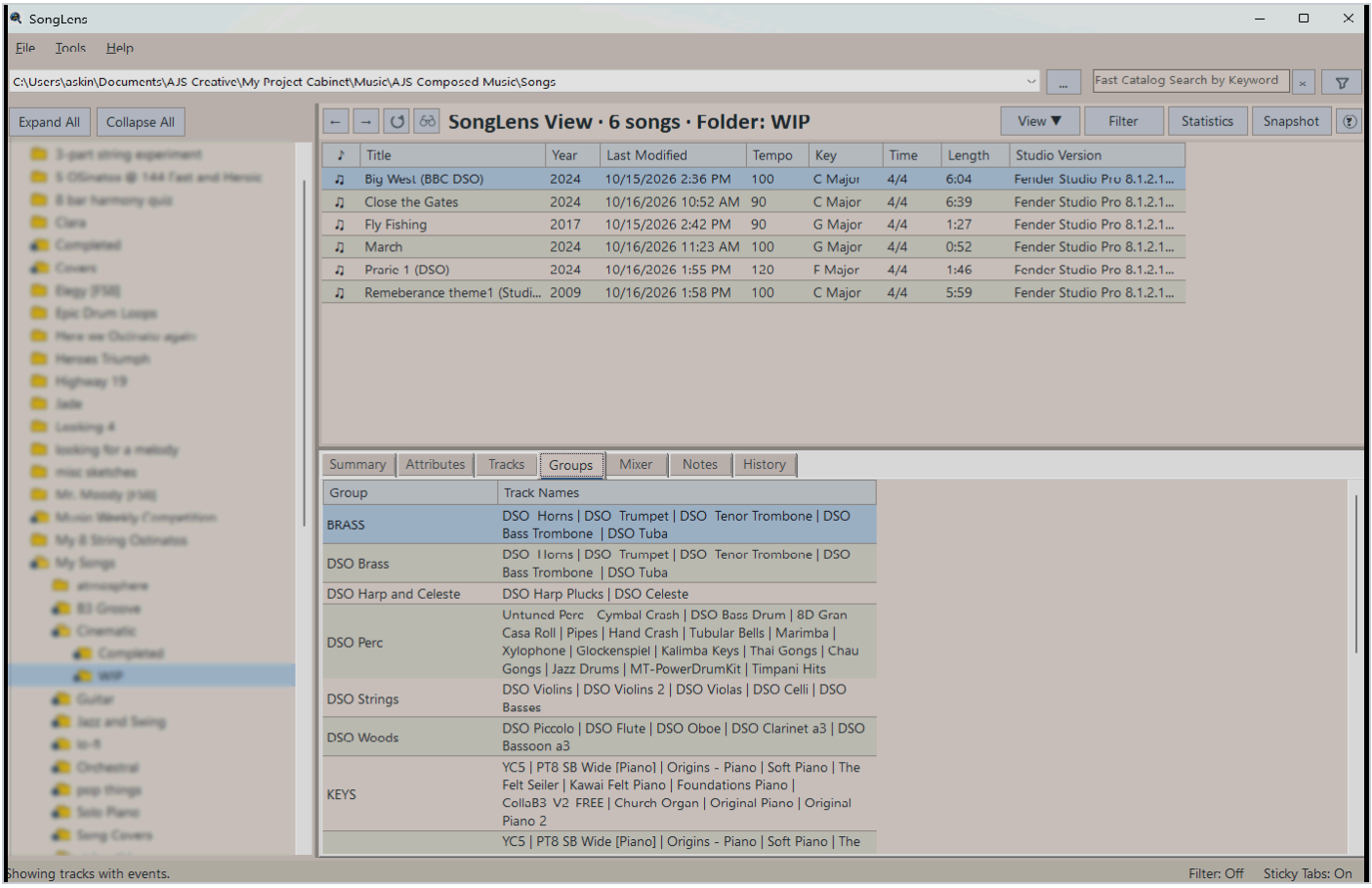
Tracks detail tab and Track View Options

Groups

Shows:

- Group
- Track Names

This helps identify folder or group organization inside the song.

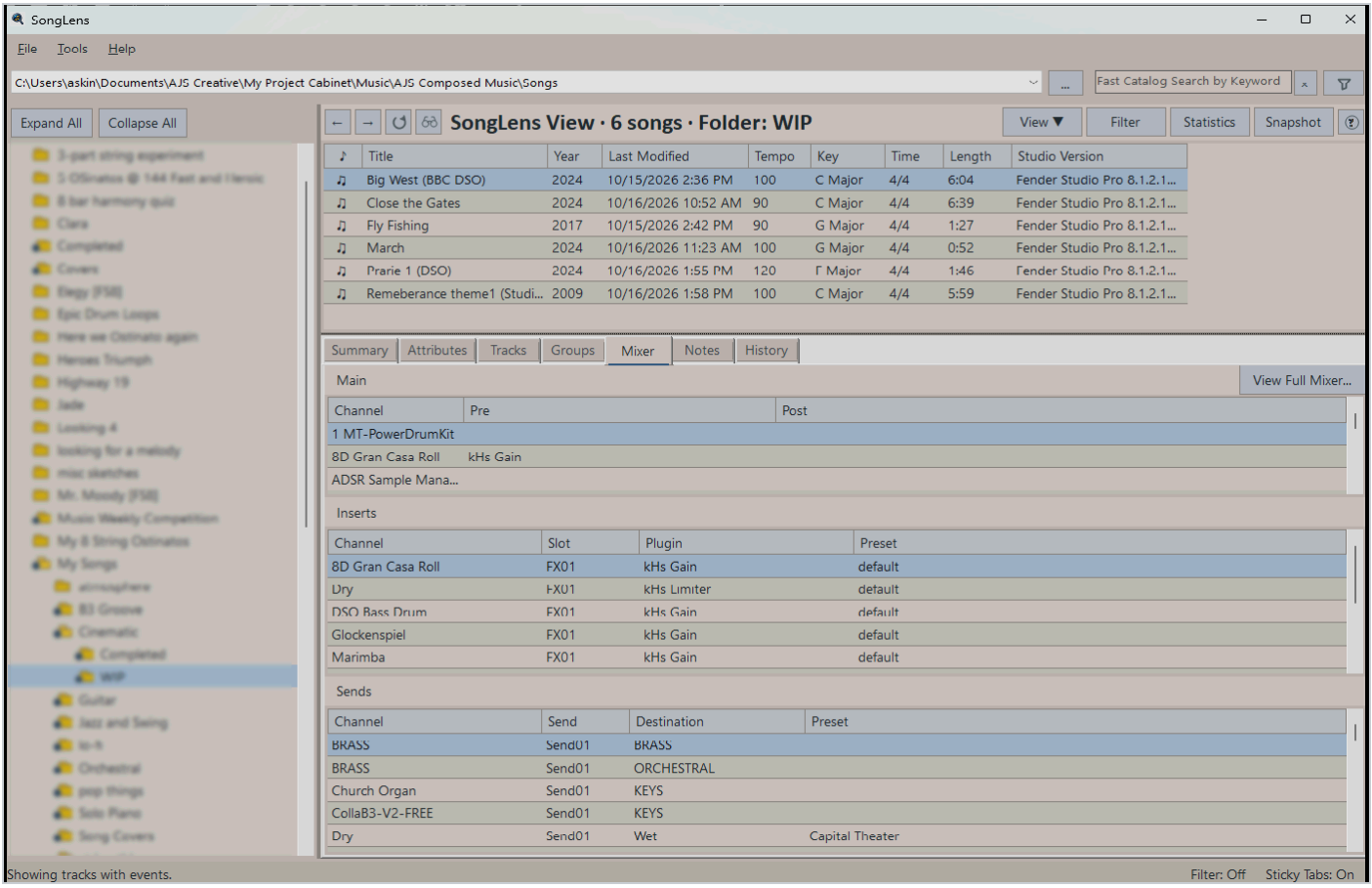


Groups detail tab

Mixer

The Mixer tab is broken into three sections:

- Main
- Inserts
- Sends



Mixer detail tab

Mixer Main

Shows the main channel insert chain, split into:

- `Pre`
- `Post`

when the source song exposes those sections.

Mixer Inserts

Shows insert details such as:

- Channel
- Slot
- Plugin
- Preset

Mixer Sends

Shows send details such as:

- Channel

- Slot
- Destination
- Preset

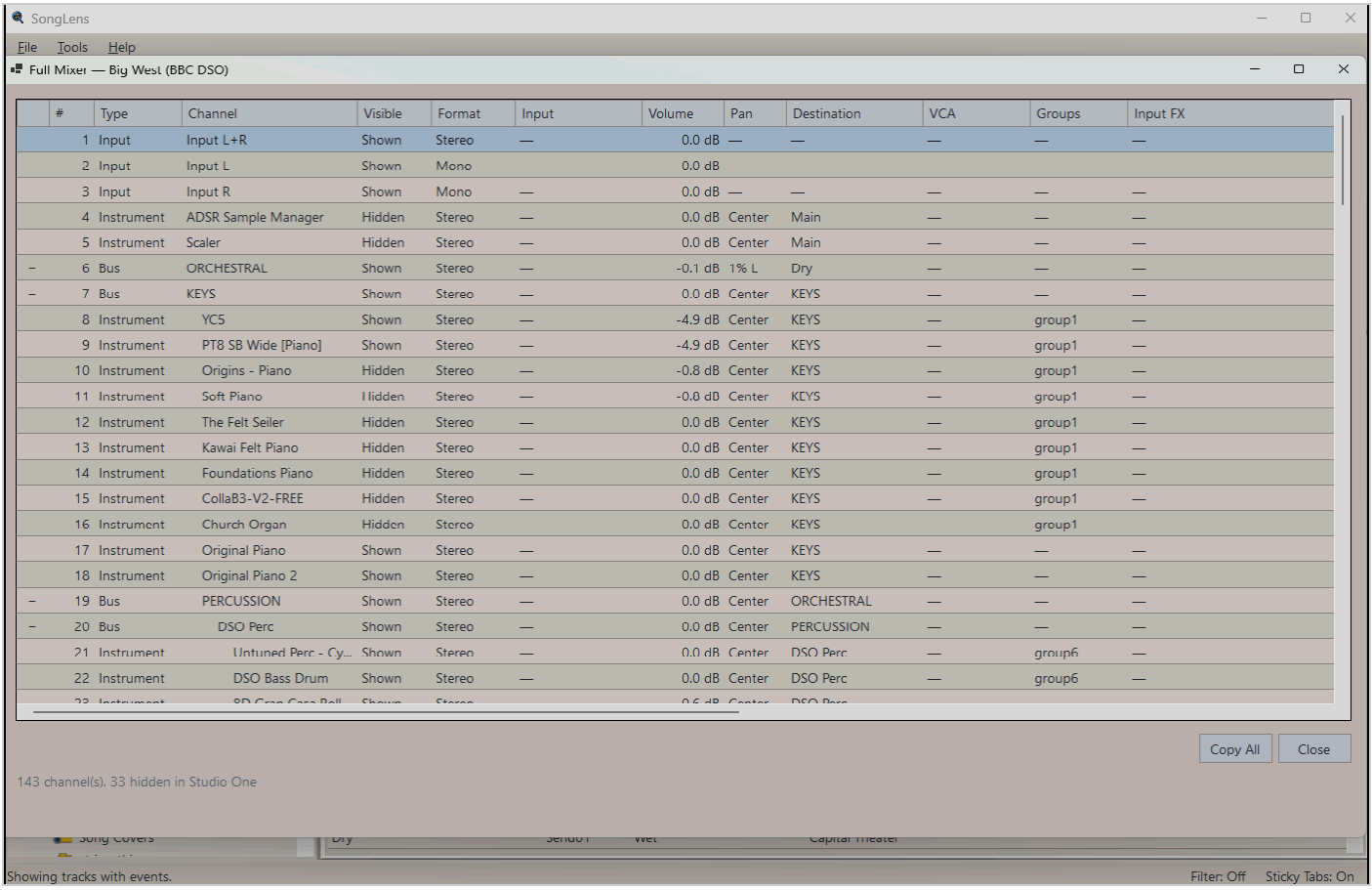
Full Mixer

Choose `View Full Mixer...` to inspect every mixer channel, including inputs, outputs, audio and instrument channels, buses, FX channels, aux channels, VCAs, and the listen bus.

Channels follow their saved Studio One console order. The view also identifies channels hidden in Studio One and shows channel format, input and output routing, VCA assignment, volume, pan, channel groups, detailed input/pre/post inserts, detailed sends, and mute, solo, solo-safe, disabled, or expanded state.

Folder-track mixer channels have an expand/collapse control in the leftmost column. Collapsing one hides all mixer channels routed through that folder, including descendants of nested folder tracks.

Insert details include slot, plugin, preset, and bypass state. Send details include destination, level, pan, pre/post-fader placement, and bypass state. Use `Copy All` to copy the complete mixer table with headers.



Full Mixer window

Notes

Shows the song-level `notes.txt` content.

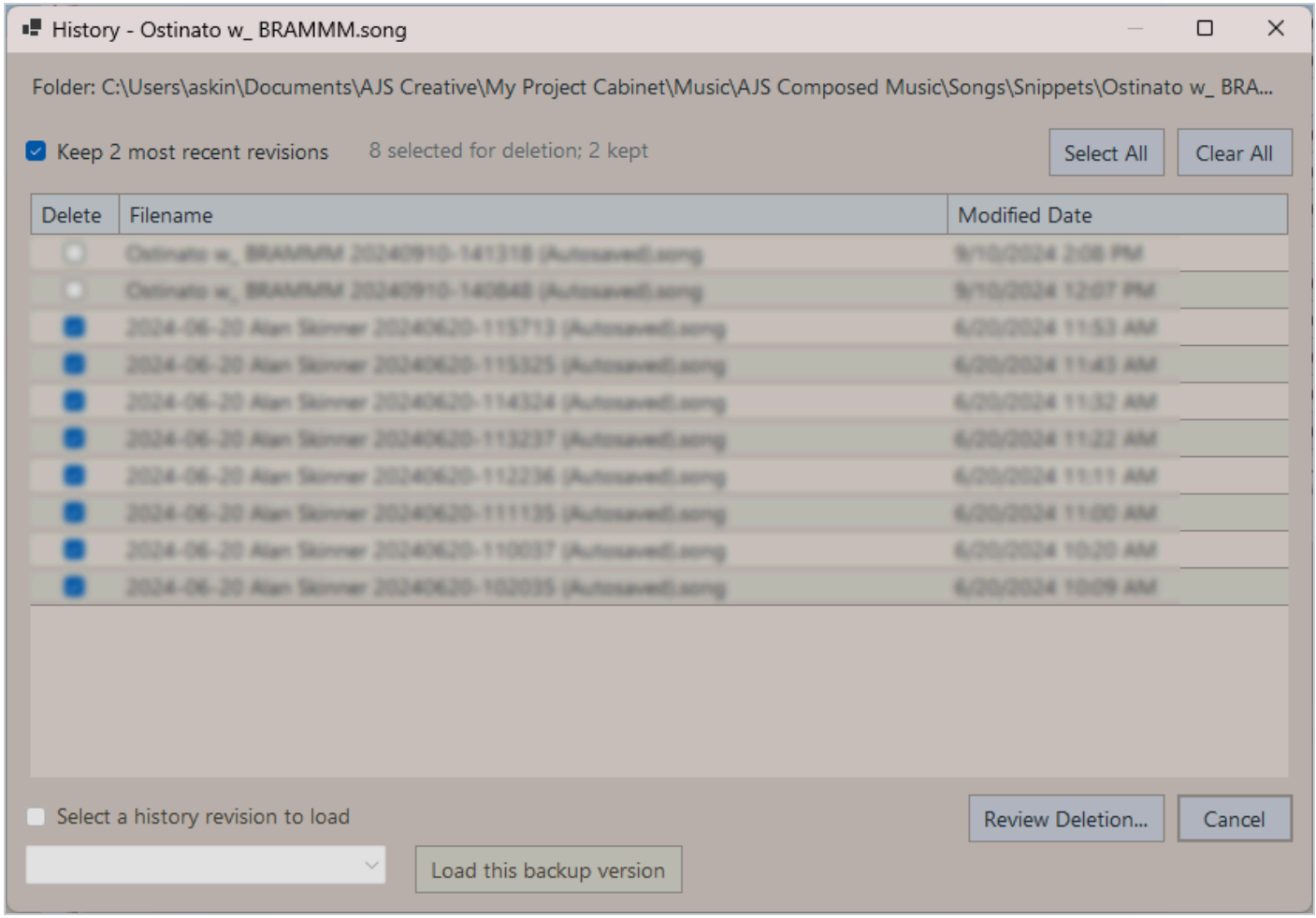
History

Selecting `History` opens the History folder viewer for the selected song.

The **Delete** checkboxes explicitly identify the files selected for deletion. Use **Select All** or **Clear All** for bulk changes. The retention option leaves the configured number of most recent `.song` revisions unchecked automatically.

Choose **Review Deletion** to see the deletion count and a dated list of every file being kept. SongLens deletes only checked files and always requires this second confirmation.

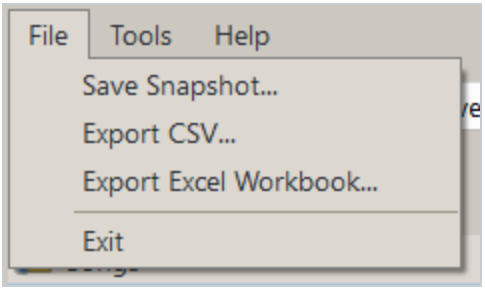
To open a saved revision without returning History files to the main catalog, select its row and enable the **Load _filename_** checkbox. Choose a compatible application from the newest-first list, then select **Load this backup version**. Changing the selected revision clears the checkbox as a safeguard.



History cleanup window

Exports And Snapshots

Export and snapshot commands are available from the **File** menu.



File menu

Export CSV

Use `File > Export CSV...` to export:

- The current search results
- The current song
- The full library, depending on the current view

CSV export lets you:

- Choose which fields to include
- Include numbered Track Notes separately from Song Notes
- Include a numbered list of Disabled Tracks
- Save your preferred export field set for later use
- Include newer sections such as:
- Groups
- Mixer Main
- Mixer Inserts
- Mixer Sends

Selected mixer data is written to a companion `-mixer-details.csv` file so the main catalog remains one row per song.

Export Excel Workbook

Use `File > Export Excel Workbook...` to create one `.xlsx` file containing:

- A `Catalog` worksheet with one row per song
- A normalized `Mixer Details` worksheet with one row per mixer item

- Links from song names in `Catalog` to their first matching row in `Mixer Details`

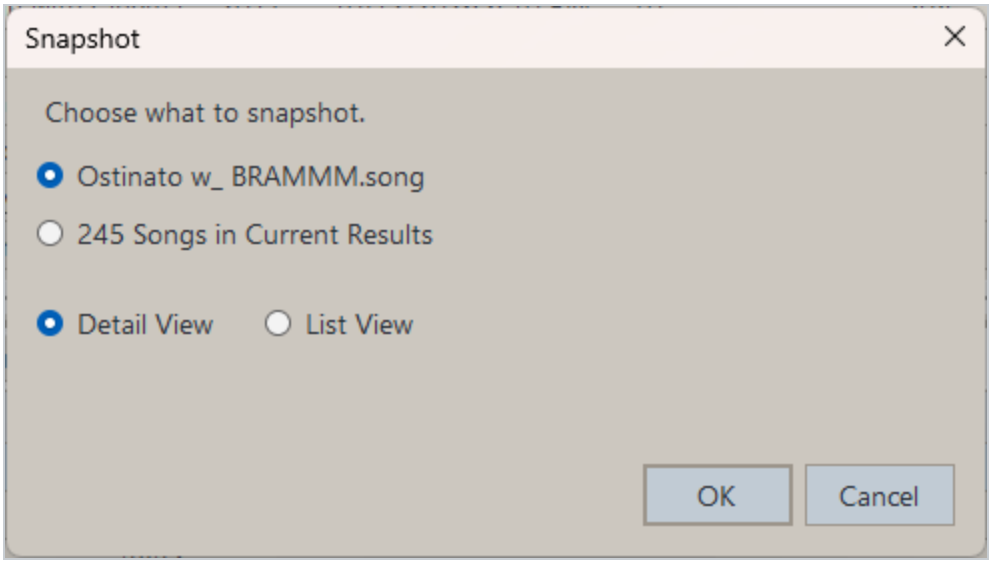
Both worksheets include frozen headers and column filters.

Save Snapshot

Use `File > Save Snapshot...` or the `Snapshot` button above the detail tabs.

When SongLens View contains more than one song, choose:

- The selected song, which defaults to Detail View
- Every song in the current folder or search result, which defaults to List View



Choose a single-song snapshot

For a multi-song snapshot:

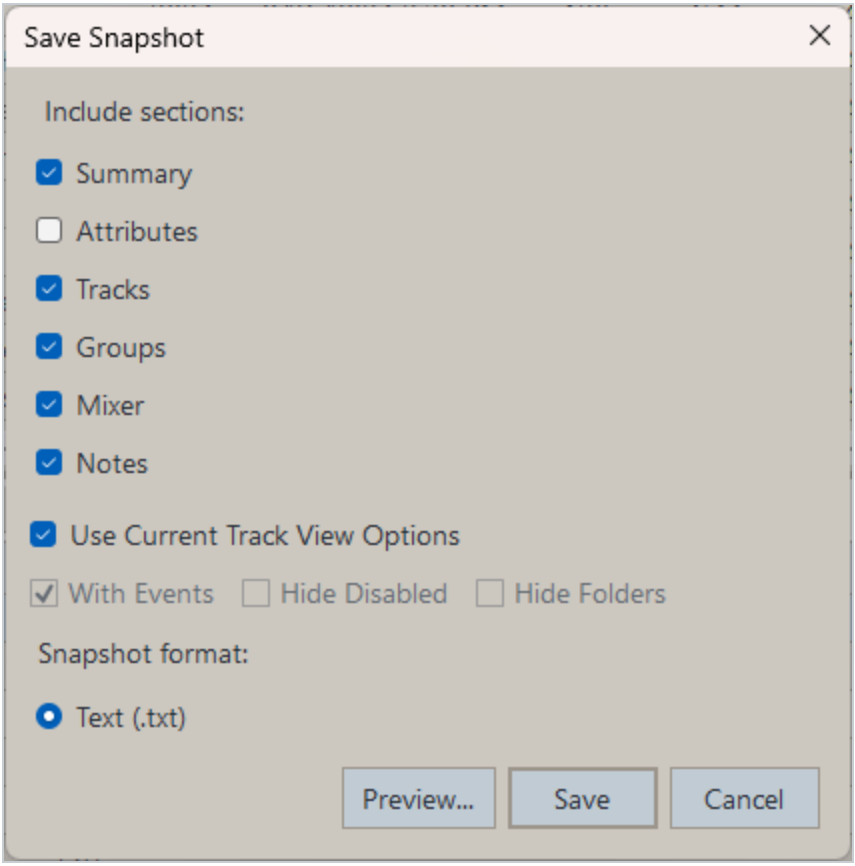
- List View captures the visible SongLens View columns, their display order, the current sort order, and every visible row.
- Detail View creates the full report for every song, with a clear separator between songs.

List View goes directly to the save dialog. Detail View opens Snapshot Preview first so you can choose the report sections and review the result.

Detailed snapshots use your current Track View Options by default. Clear `Use Current Track View Options` to choose snapshot-only settings for:

- With Events
- Hide Disabled
- Hide Folders

These overrides affect only the snapshot output. They do not change the Track View Options dropdown or your saved preferences.

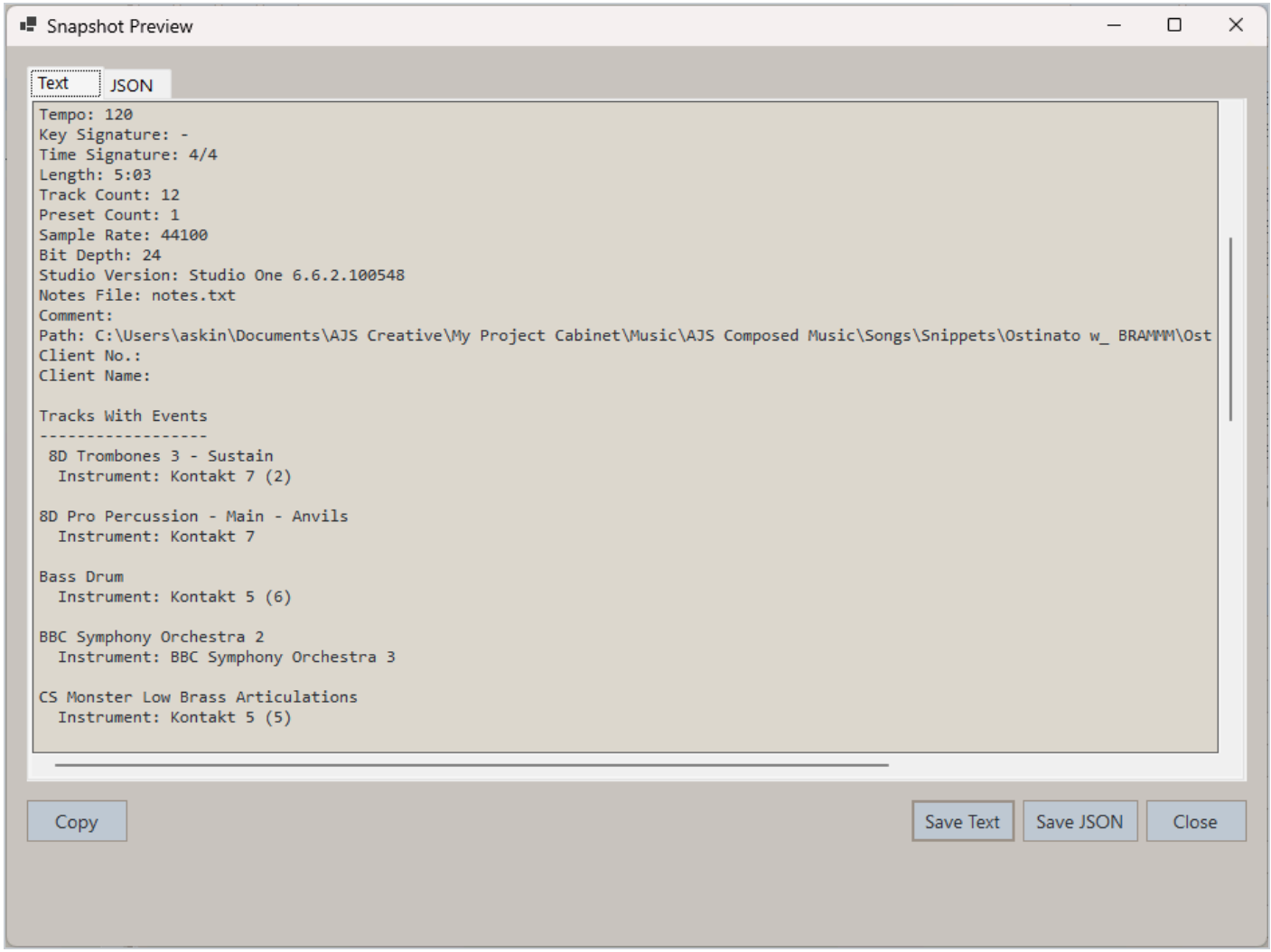


Save Snapshot options

Snapshots can be saved as:

- Text
- JSON

Snapshot Preview lets you review the result before saving.



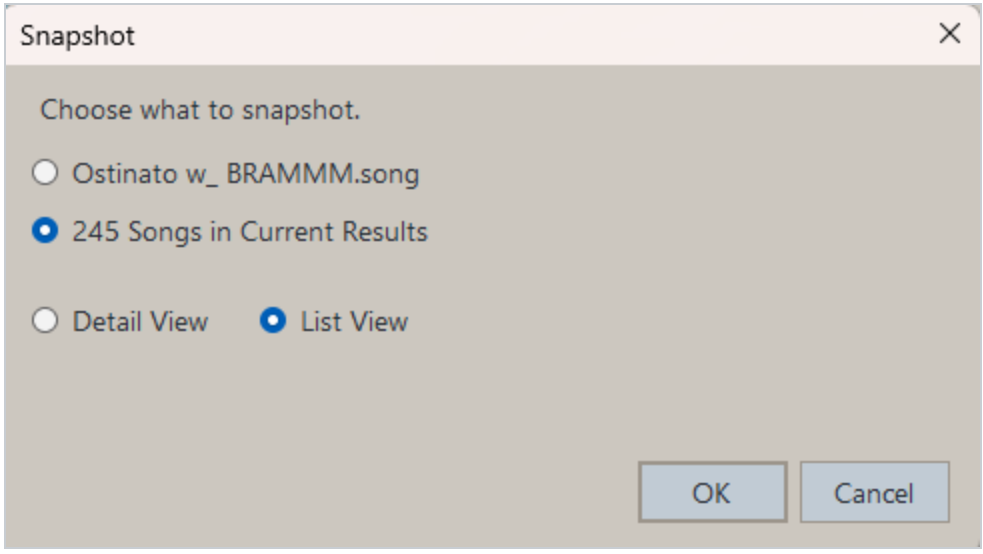
Single-song Snapshot Preview

Snapshots can include sections such as:

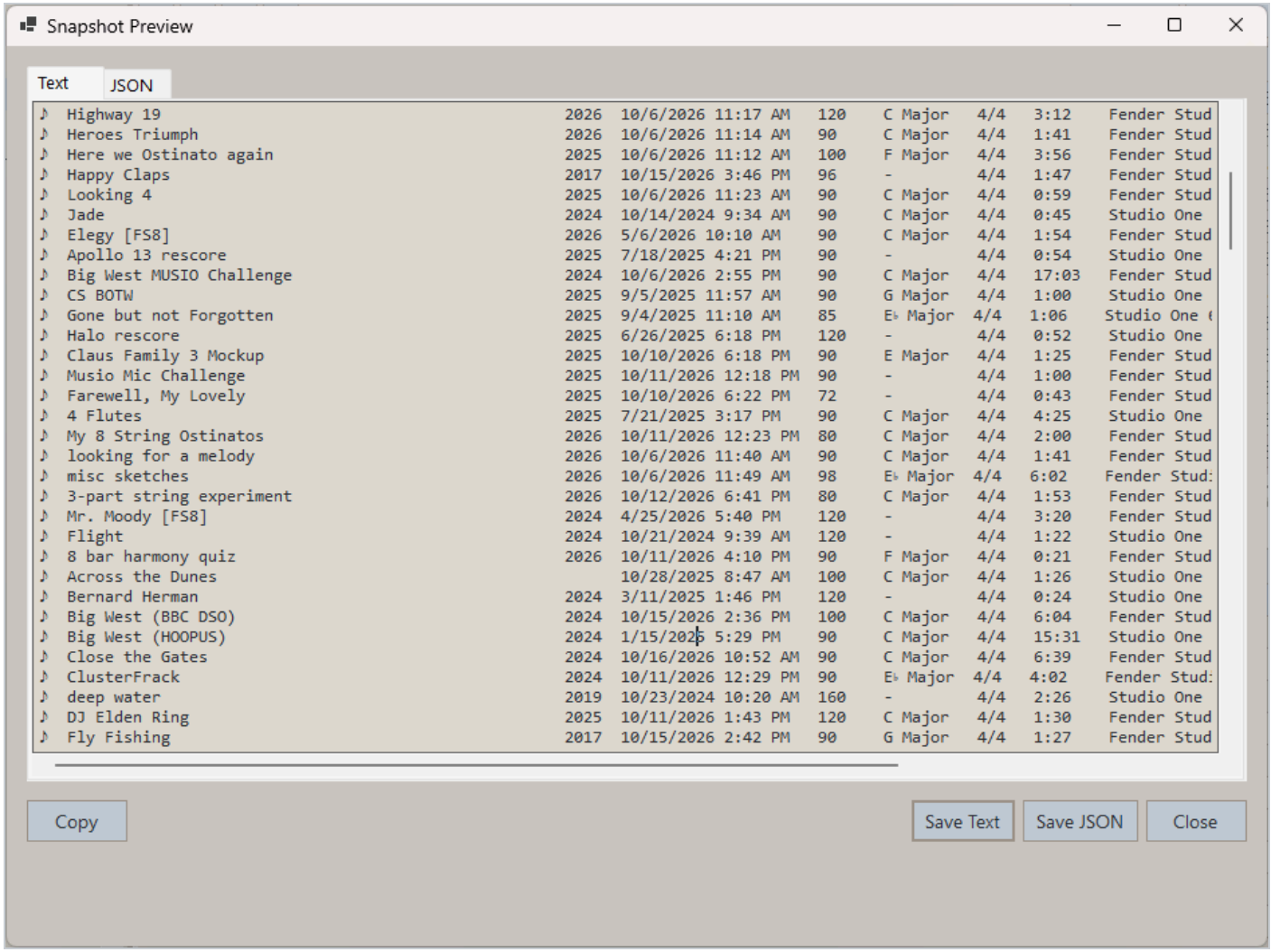
- Summary
- Attributes
- Tracks
- Groups
- Mixer
- Notes

Tab visibility is separate from snapshot selection. Hiding a tab does not automatically remove that section from snapshots.

For a list of the current results, choose the multi-song scope and **List View**.



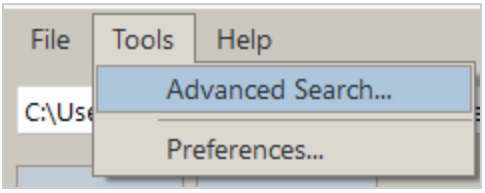
Choose a multiple-song snapshot



Multiple-song Snapshot Preview

Preferences And Themes

Use `Tools > Preferences...` to adjust application settings.

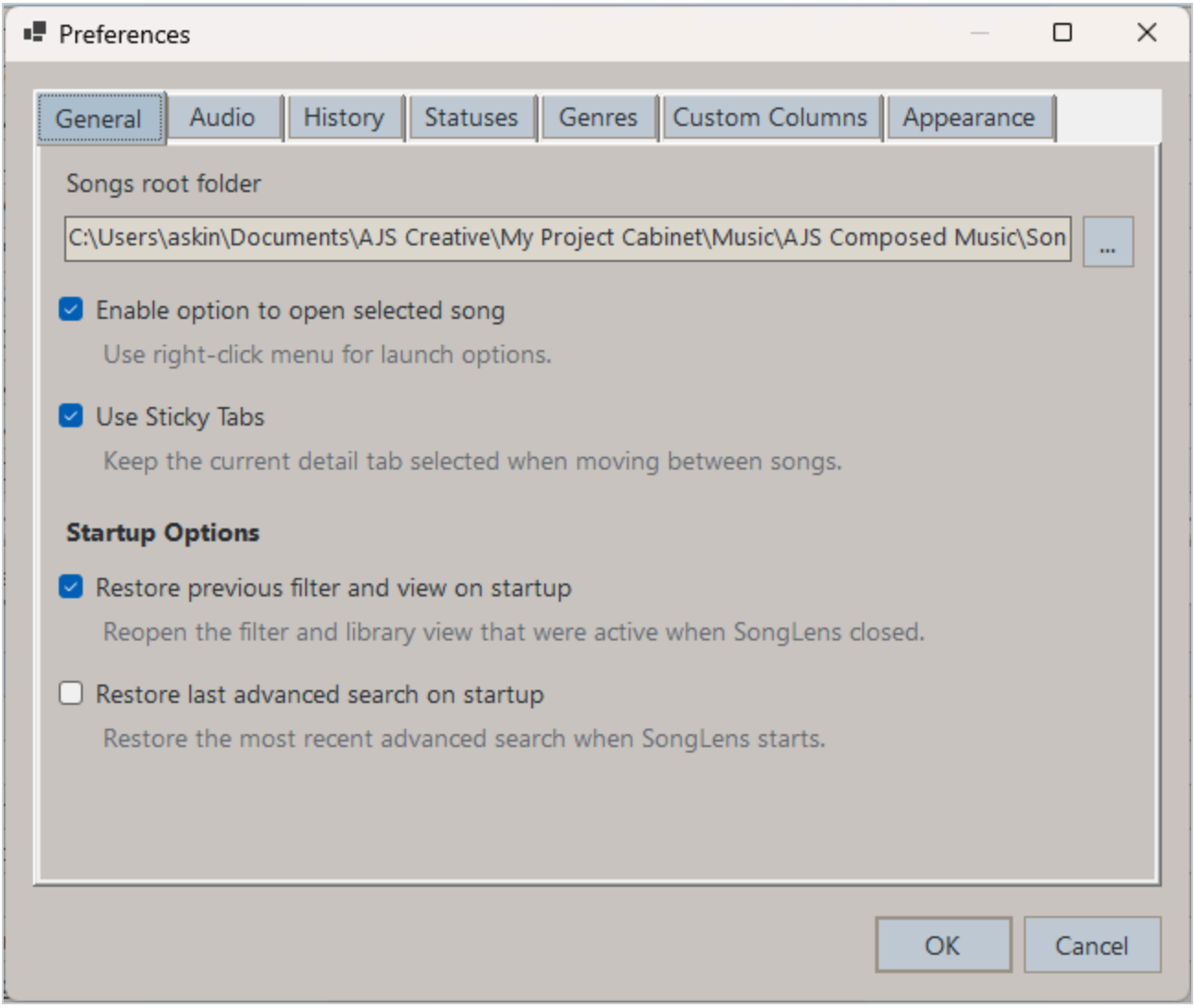


Tools menu with Preferences

General

The General tab includes options such as:

- Songs root folder
- Whether to restore the previous filter/view on startup
- Whether to restore the last advanced search on startup
- Whether SongLens should launch songs in compatible apps

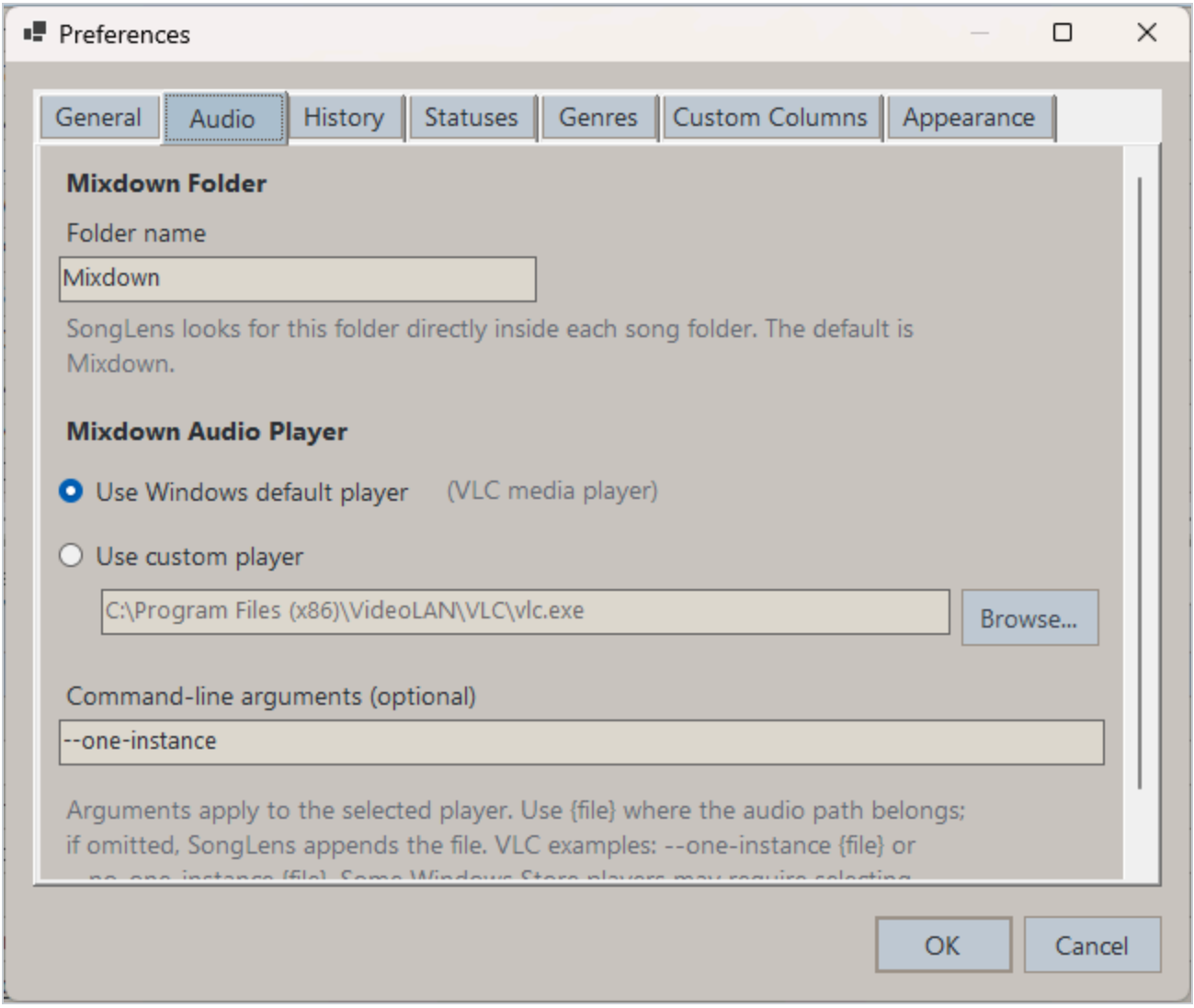


General preferences

Audio

The Audio tab controls where SongLens looks for matching mixdown audio and how those files are opened. The folder name defaults to `Mixdown`, but you can change it to the folder name used by your workflow. Use the Windows default player or select a custom player executable. The selected player can also have optional command-line arguments. When the Windows default player is selected, SongLens resolves its registered executable for the mixdown's file type. Use `{file}` where the selected mixdown path should be inserted; when `{file}` is omitted, SongLens appends the path automatically. For example, VLC accepts `--one-instance {file}` to reuse one player or `--no-one-instance {file}` to request a separate player.

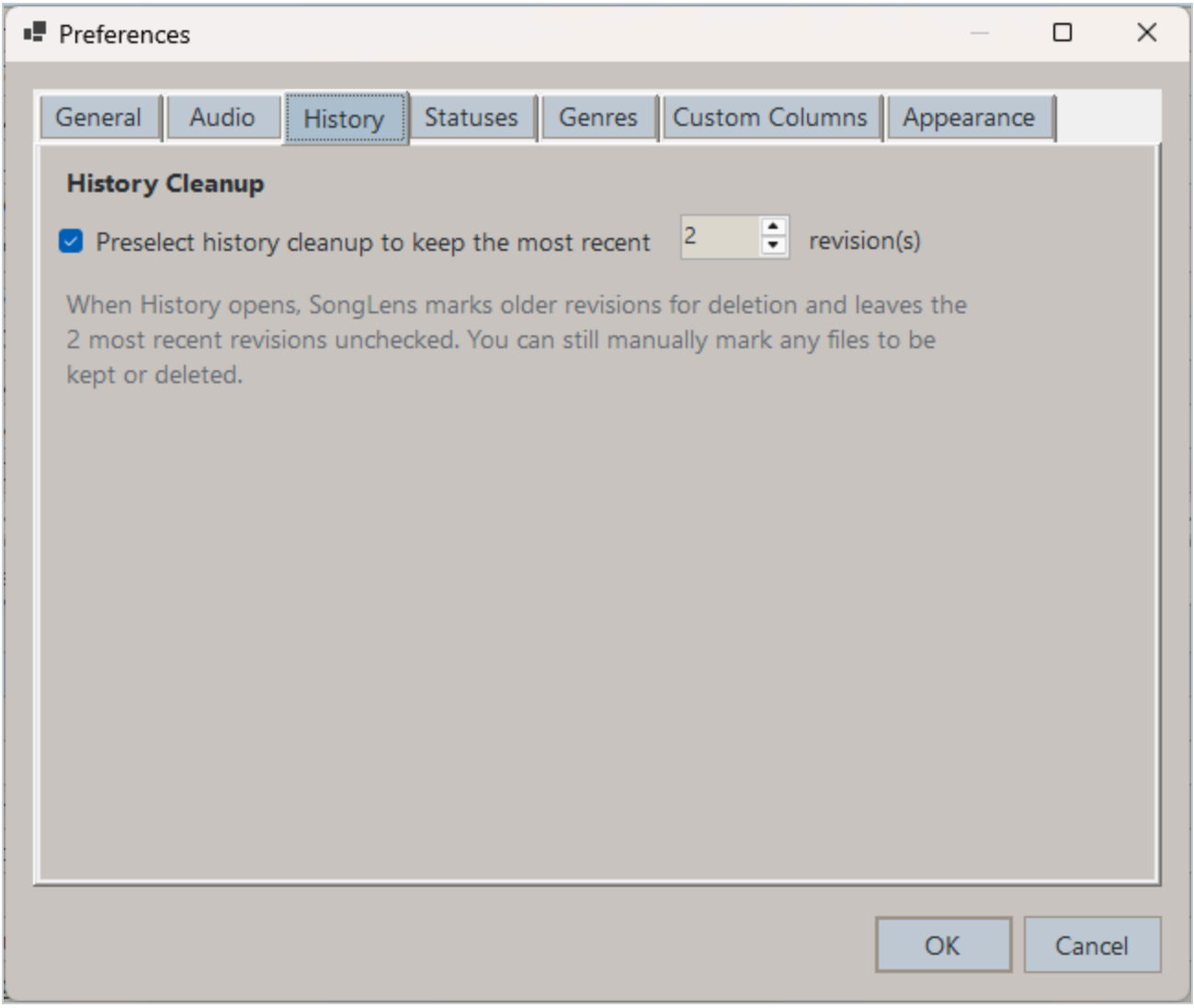
SongLens lists every supported audio file in the configured folder. Files whose base name matches the `.song` filename, including numbered versions such as `My Song (2).wav`, appear first.



Audio preferences

History

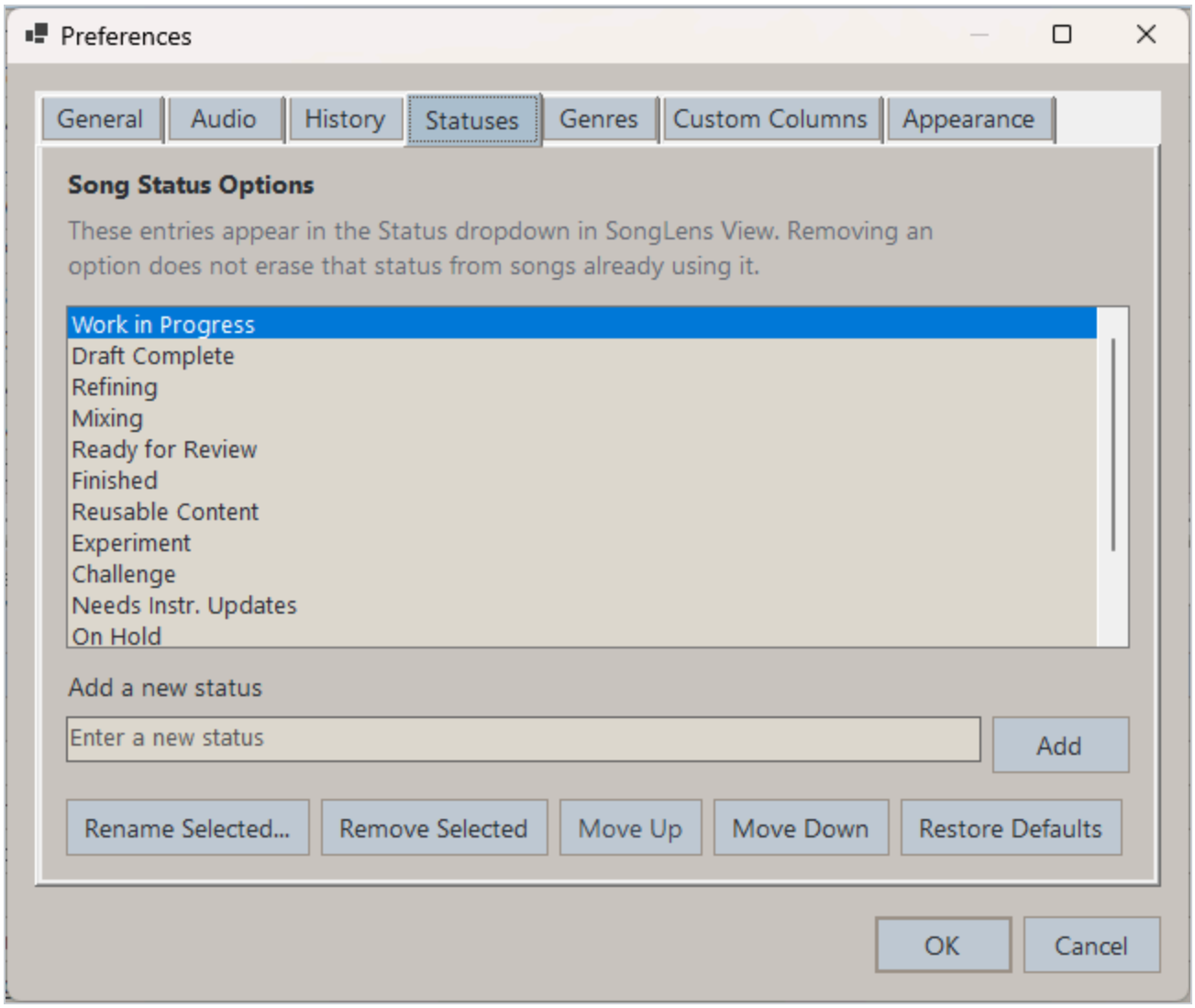
The History tab controls the cleanup preset used by the History viewer. Enable the preset and choose how many of the most recent history revisions to keep. SongLens then preselects older revisions for deletion when the viewer opens; it never deletes them without review and confirmation.



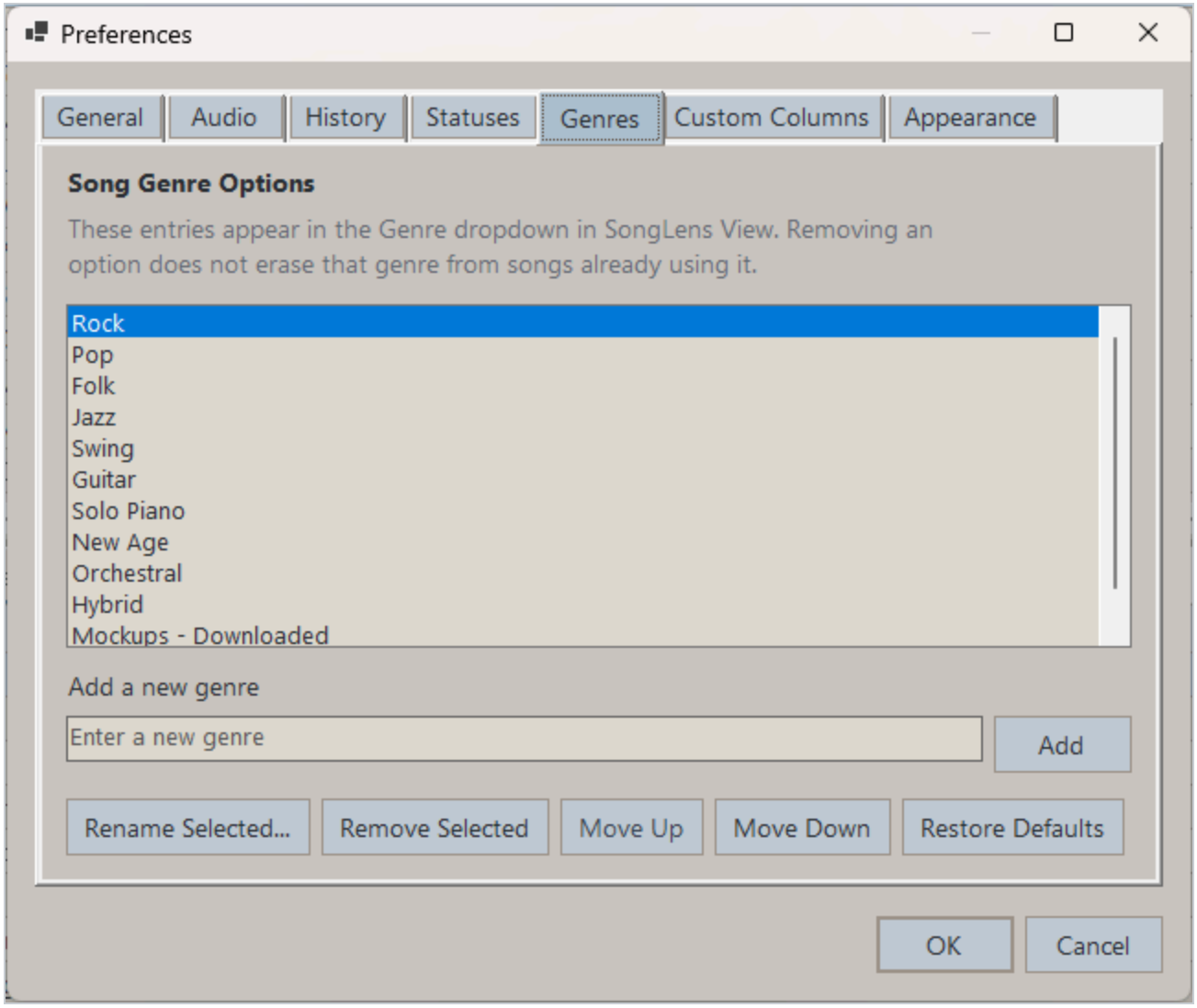
History preferences

Statuses, Genres, And Custom Columns

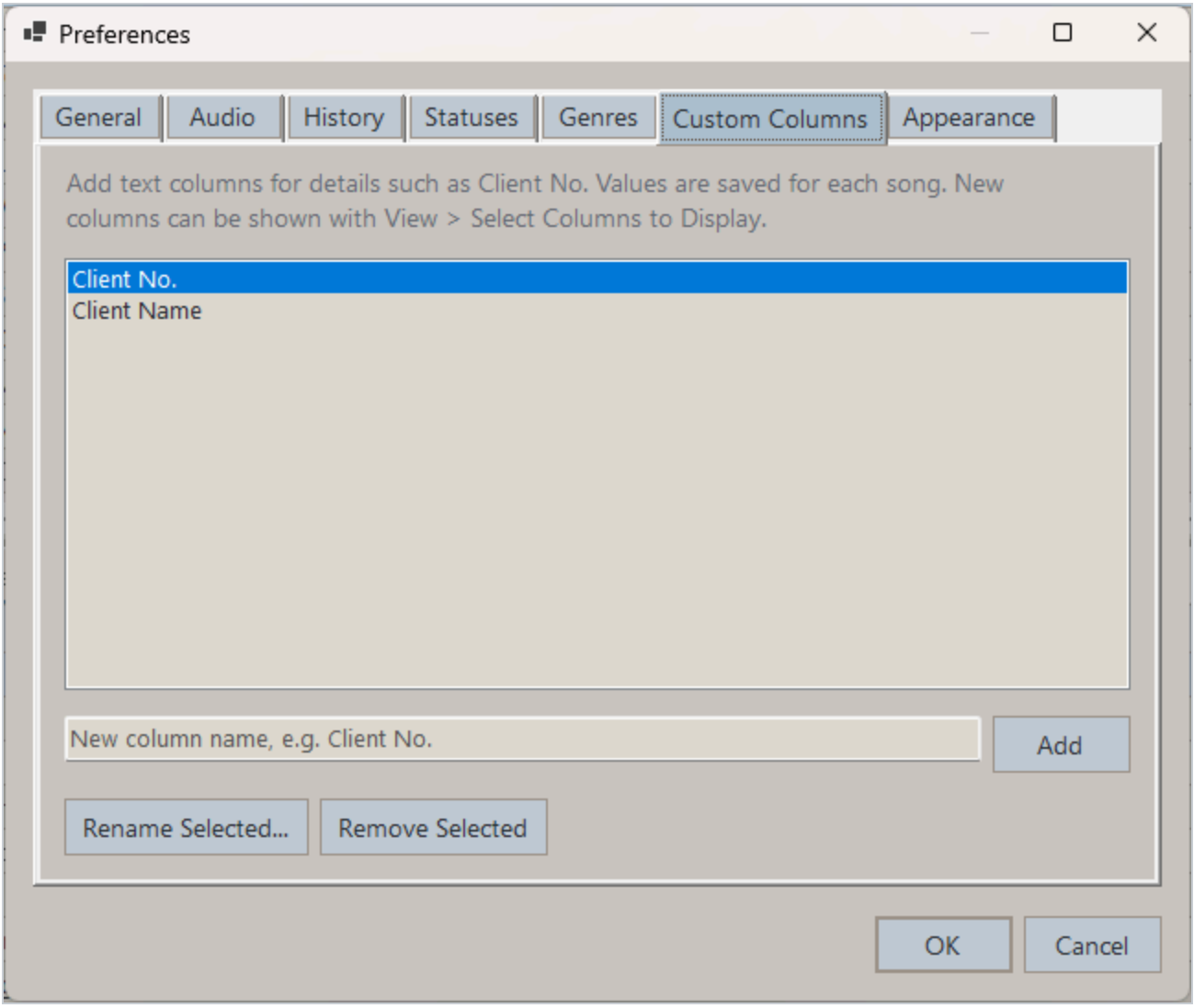
Use the **Statuses** and **Genres** tabs to add, rename, remove, reorder, or restore the choices available in SongLens View. The **Custom Columns** tab manages additional text columns for workflow-specific information such as client numbers or names.



Status preferences



Genre preferences



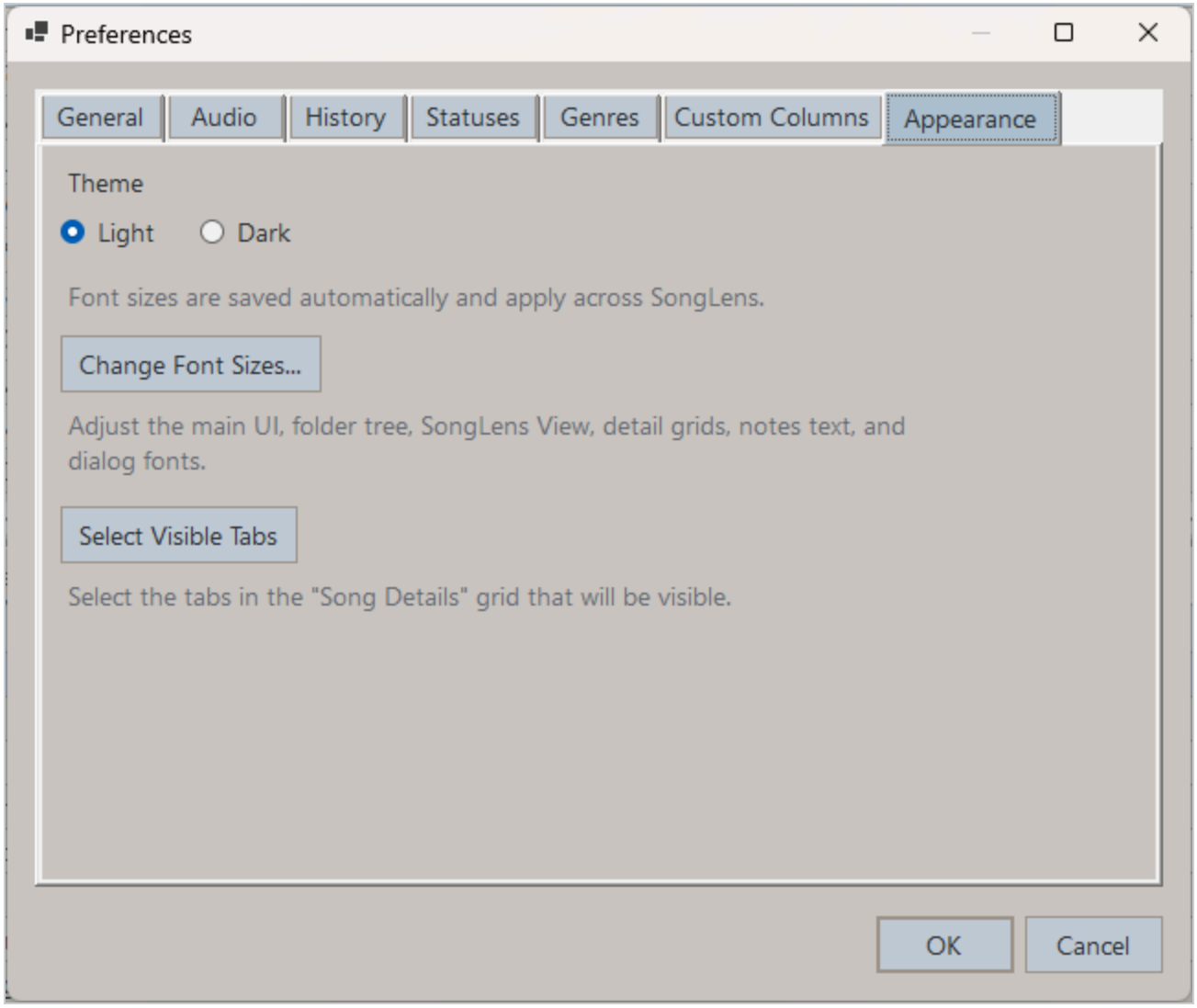
Custom column preferences

Appearance

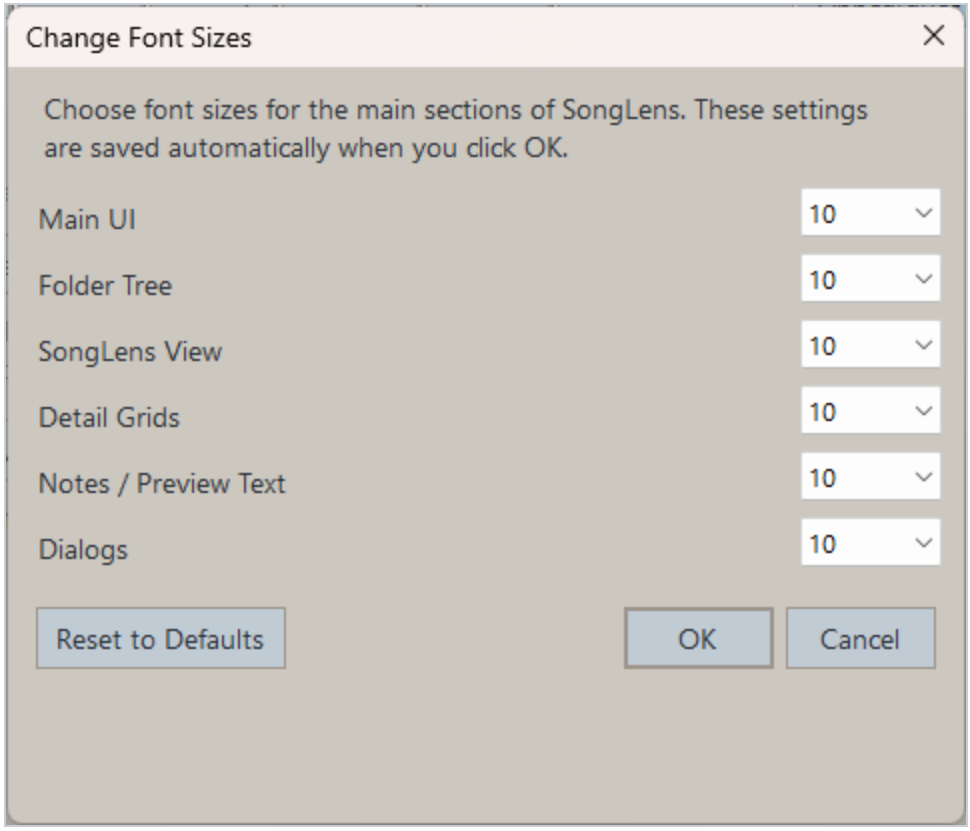
The Appearance tab includes options such as:

- Light or Dark theme
- Font size preferences for:
- Main UI
- Folder Tree
- SongLens View
- Detail Grids
- Notes / Preview Text
- Dialogs

Preferences is resizable, and SongLens remembers its size.



Appearance preferences



Change Font Sizes

Themes And Saved UI State

SongLens remembers:

- Songs root folder
- Theme choice
- Saved grid layouts
- SongLens View column visibility
- SongLens View column order
- Mixdown folder and audio-player preferences
- History cleanup retention preset
- Visible detail tabs
- Main window size
- Preferences window size
- Font size preferences
- Filter preferences
- Saved CSV export fields

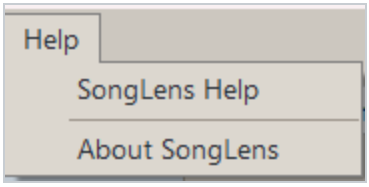
The default theme for new installs or fresh config state is `Light`.

Dates and times are shown using the current Windows regional settings.

Tempo values are rounded for easier reading.

Tips And Compatibility

SongLens Help and version information are available from the **Help** menu.



Help menu

Tips

- Double-click a song row to reveal it in Windows Explorer
- Right-click song rows and folders to see available actions quickly
- If SongLens View shows multiple songs, click the exact song you want to add to `Recently Viewed`
- If a song seems buried, use `Expand All` to reveal the full visible folder structure
- If a song does not appear, verify that it is a regular `.song` file and not an autosaved copy
- After changing your song library outside SongLens, use the **Refresh** icon beside the SongLens View heading
- If the Fast Search text is no longer useful, clear it and search again from the start

Platform And Compatibility

- Supported target: Windows 11 x64
- Packaged releases are published as self-contained `win-x64` builds
- Studio One is not required to inspect `.song` files, but users do need access to a valid songs folder